

REVIEW QUESTIONS

- 1 Identify three client characteristics that barbers should be aware of before beginning the shave service.
- 2 List the steps to prepare the client for a shave.
- 3 What effect does shaving cream have on facial hair?
- 4 Describe how to work shaving cream into a lather.
- 5 What effect do hot towels have on facial hair?
- 6 Identify several skin conditions that may prohibit the application of hot steam towels.
- 7 Identify the four razor-holding positions or strokes.
- 8 What three razor strokes are used in facial shaving?
- 9 Shaving strokes should be performed in what relation to the grain of the hair?
- 10 Identify the number of shaving areas of the face.
- 11 What two types of shaves are performed in a standard shave service?
- 12 Explain the difference between the first-time-over shave and the once-over shave.
- 13 List the finishing steps of a facial shave.
- 14 Explain how a close shave differs from a standard shave and why it may be undesirable.
- 15 List the important characteristics used to determine a mustache design.
- 16 Explain why some barbers prefer to cut and style the hair before performing a beard trim service.

CHAPTER GLOSSARY

backhand (BAK-HAND)	p. 342	razor position and stroke used in 4 of the 14 basic shaving areas: nos. 2, 6, 7, and 9; optional position for area 12
close shaving (KLOHS SHAYV-ing)	p. 349	the procedure of shaving facial hair against the grain during the second-time-over shave
cutting stroke (KUT-ing STROHK)	p. 342	the correct angle of cutting the beard with a straight razor
first-time-over shave (FIRST-TYM-OH-ver SHAYV)	p. 348	first part of the standard shave consisting of shaving the 14 areas of the face; followed by the second-time-over shave to remove residual missed or rough spots
freehand (FREE-HAND)	p. 342	razor position and stroke used in 6 of the 14 shaving areas: nos. 1, 3, 4, 8, 11, and 12
neck shave (NEK SHAYV)	p. 349	shaving the areas behind the ears down the sides of the neck, and at the back neckline
once-over shave (WONCE-OH-ver SHAYV)	p. 349	single-lather shave in which the shaving strokes are made across the grain of the hair
reverse backhand (ree-VURS BAK-HAND)	p. 342	razor position and stroke used by right-handed barbers for shaving the left side of the neck behind the ear and used by left-handed barbers behind the right ear
reverse freehand (ree-VURS FREE-HAND)	p. 342	razor position and stroke used in 4 of the 14 basic shaving areas: nos. 5, 10, 13, and 14
second-time-over shave (SEK-und-TYM-OH-ver SHAYV)	p. 348	follows a regular shave to remove any rough or uneven spots using water instead of lather; may be considered a form of close shaving
styptic powder (STIP-tik POW-dur)	p. 352	alum powder or liquid used to stop bleeding of nicks and cuts

14

MEN'S HAIRCUTTING
AND STYLING

CHAPTER OUTLINE

INTRODUCTION

WHY STUDY MEN'S HAIRCUTTING AND STYLING?

UNDERSTAND THE IMPORTANCE OF THE CLIENT CONSULTATION

KNOW BASIC PRINCIPLES OF HAIRCUTTING AND STYLING

DESCRIBE HAIRCUTTING TECHNIQUES

RECOGNIZE BASIC HAIRCUT STYLES

EXPLAIN HAIRCUT FINISH WORK

IDENTIFY STYLING TECHNIQUES

DISCUSS SAFETY PRECAUTIONS FOR HAIRCUTTING AND STYLING

PROCEDURES 14-1 TO 14-16

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

LO1

Explain the importance of the client consultation and consider questions that help you envision the client's desired outcome.

LO2

Describe anatomical features that influence haircutting and styling.

LO3

Identify the sections of the head as applied to haircutting.

LO4

Identify tapering and blending areas.

LO5

Define design elements used in haircutting and styling.

LO6

Define basic terms used in haircutting and styling.

LO7

Explain basic cutting techniques using shears, clippers, and razors.

LO8

Describe basic haircut styles.

LO9

Describe haircut finish work.

LO10

Describe basic styling techniques.

LO11

Discuss haircutting and styling safety precautions.

LO12

Demonstrate basic haircuts and styling techniques.

Introduction

The art of haircutting involves the precise designing, cutting, and shaping of the client's hair. Mastering this art requires the competent use of a variety of tools, implements, and techniques. The same general techniques are used in men's and women's haircutting. The differences between the two are usually evident in the overall design line, the contour or shape, and the finished style.

A good haircut is the foundation of a good hairstyle. The importance of this simple truth cannot be overstated. To perform a good haircut, you need to be able to cut, blend, and taper the hair using clippers, shears, and razors. Diligent practice and application of these skills will help form the foundation for your future success; however, the learning doesn't stop with your barber license. When working in the barbershop, there will be occasions when a client requests a haircut that you might not feel confident about performing or that requires you to step out of your comfort zone. This is to be expected, so do not panic. If you've learned the basics while in school, you should be able to create a plan of action that utilizes the skills you've mastered so that you can perform the haircut with confidence.

Hairstyling has been defined as the art of arranging the hair in a particular style that is appropriately suited to the cut and that best fits the client's physical characteristics and personality. In men's haircutting, very often the finished cut *is* the style; when we use the term *styling*, we usually refer to combing, brushing, blowdrying, or other methods used to redirect or place the hair into its finished look. Both the haircut and style should accentuate the client's best features and minimize the weakest ones. This rule requires that the barber consider the client's head shape, facial features, neck length, hairline, and hair texture. The barber also needs to be guided by the client's preferences, personality, and lifestyle so the client can manage the style in between shop visits.

why study

MEN'S HAIRCUTTING AND STYLING?

Barbers should study and have a thorough understanding of men's haircutting and styling because:

- Haircutting is a basic skill that provides the foundation for hair design and styling.
- Practicing skills and techniques is critical to being able to perform balanced and proportionate haircuts and styles for clients.
- The more practice and experience barbers have, the better able they will be to meet their clients' needs.
- Meeting clients' haircutting and styling needs results in satisfied customers and the opportunity to build repeat business.

Understand the Importance of the Client Consultation

After reading this section, you will be able to:

- LO1** Explain the importance of the client consultation and consider questions that help you envision the client's desired outcome.

The client consultation is a conversation between you and the client about the client's desires and expectations of the service you will perform. It also facilitates the hair and scalp analysis step so that you can determine what can or cannot be done with the client's hair and helps to eliminate any guesswork about the haircut or style to be performed. During the consultation you should be able to:

- determine what the client wants his hair to look like or to be able to do with his hair;
- discuss the client's lifestyle as it relates to his daily hair maintenance routine;
- identify hair conditions, such as density, texture, or length, that may limit or enhance cutting and styling options;
- discover scalp conditions that may prohibit moving forward with the service;
- identify hair conditions that require special treatment;
- offer your professional advice or alternative suggestions;
- agree with the client on the type of haircut and finishing services to be performed.

With this information you can make a more informed judgment about what can or cannot be done to meet the client's expectations (Figure 14-1).

figure 14-1

Know if you can meet your client's expectations.



DISCUSS COMMON QUESTIONS ASKED DURING A CONSULTATION

After draping the client and facing him toward the mirror you can begin the consultation with a few basic questions:

- *How long has it been since your last haircut?*

Knowing that on average hair grows at the rate of about ½ inch per month, you should be able to envision the preferred length of the hair before it grew out and needed to be cut again.

- *Do you prefer a similar style or are you looking for something new?*

The answer to this question can lead you directly to the cutting stage or to further discussion with the client about appropriate styles and options.

figure 14-2

Communicate specifics with your client.

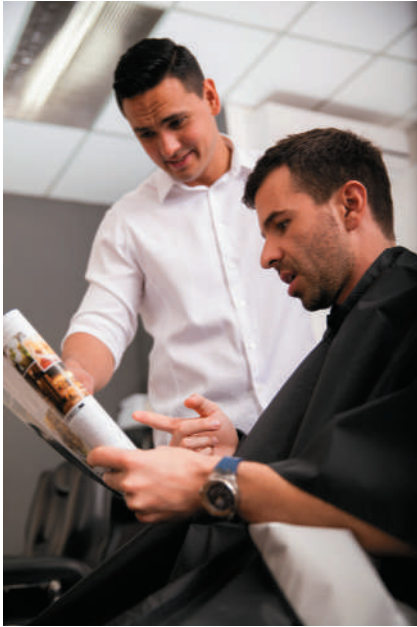
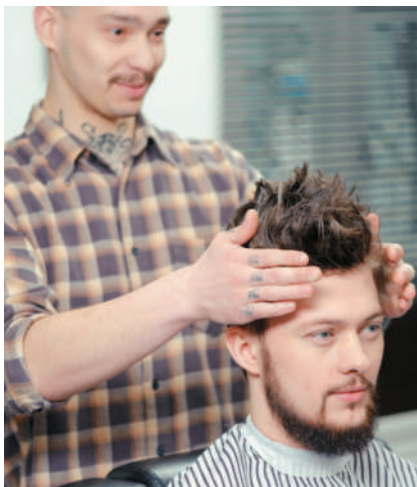


figure 14-3

Use the mirror to help your client envision the style.



- *What is your usual morning routine (shampoo, blowdry, etc.)?*

This answer will indicate how much time the client is willing to spend on his hair care every day.

- *Did you have any particular problems with your previous cut or style?*

This question provides the client an opportunity to open dialogue about specific hair-related issues such as problem areas, length, fullness, growth and wave patterns, hair texture, density, and color.

Next, you will need more details to visualize what the finished cut and style should look like. While analyzing the client's hair and scalp (Figure 14-2), ask specific questions about the style the client expects and then clarify the answers; "a little off the top," "just a trim," and "over the ears" are some commonly heard phrases in the barbershop; but what do these phrases actually tell you about the haircut? Would you feel confident about cutting the client's hair without finding out just what the client means? Consider some of the reasons why these phrases do not provide enough information for you to proceed with the haircut; as you may note, they do not confirm what the client means:

- How is "a little" measured? Is it $\frac{1}{4}$ inch, 1 inch, or somewhere in between?
- What does the client consider a "trim"? Clean up the hairline, take $\frac{1}{2}$ inch off all over, or something else?
- To the client, does "over the ears" mean covering the ears or cutting around the ears?

These are just a few examples of misinterpretations that can occur during a consultation and why it is so important that you listen and understand what the client is telling you. Before beginning the haircut, explain or summarize what you will be doing based on what the client has told you. Use the mirror to show him how you have interpreted what he has said (Figure 14-3). When in doubt, ask more questions for clarity. This will benefit you, your client, and the final result. With practice and experience, you will develop your own questions to gain the information you need to perform the haircut with confidence and a clear plan of execution. Asking these questions helps you **envisioning** (EN-vijg-ohn-ing) the haircut before beginning the actual procedure.

A Word about Trims

When a client uses the term *trim*, what he usually means is that he doesn't want his hair cut too close or wants to retain some length. If the client makes this request, you will need to understand what his concept of a *trim* is during the consultation.

The term *trim* may also mean that the client just wants his outline cleaned up in-between haircuts; a little outliner work and he is all set until his next appointment. A *tape-up* also fits into this category of trims and should consist of no more than an outline cleanup because, once you start *taping up* or cutting above the hairline, you will have to keep blending into the interior sections, which makes the service a haircut.

In still other cases, clients may ask for a trim with the idea that the price of the service will be adjusted down because less hair is cut off.

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In reality, there really isn't any such thing as a trim when used in this context because regardless of the *amount* of hair cut off, you will still have to perform a series of steps to cut the various hair sections and the service should be priced accordingly.

The best way to avoid any confusion or pricing issues for any of these interpretations of a trim is to clearly define the services on the price menu and to educate your clients about the difference in the services being offered.

Know Basic Principles of Haircutting and Styling

After reading this section, you will be able to:

- LO2 Describe anatomical features that influence haircutting and styling.
- LO3 Identify the sections of the head as applied to haircutting.
- LO4 Identify tapering and blending areas.
- LO5 Define design elements used in haircutting and styling.
- LO6 Define basic terms used in haircutting and styling.

Every haircut is a representation and advertisement of the barber's work. Pay attention to details such as client comfort, sideburn lengths, outlines, balance, and proportion and always remember that the haircut is the foundation of the hairstyle. In order to provide services that will make your clients' barbershop experience an exceptional one, you need to have a good understanding of the anatomical features, terminology, and techniques that relate to haircutting and styling.

RECOGNIZE ANATOMICAL FEATURES

As a barber, the anatomical features that will most influence the haircut and style design options for your client are his facial shape, head shape, profile, neck length, and the size and placement of his ears.

Facial Shapes

The consultation should provide sufficient information about the client's lifestyle and personality to suggest a suitable style, but a study of facial shapes will assist you in determining the best style for a client's features. The **facial shape** (FAY-shul SHAYP) of each individual is determined by the position and prominence of the facial bones. The seven general facial shapes are oval, round, inverted triangular, square, pear-shaped, oblong, and diamond. In order to recognize each facial shape for the purpose of offering correct advice, you will need to be acquainted with the characteristics of each type. With this information, you can suggest a haircut and style that complements the facial shape, similar to the way that certain clothes flatter the body.

figure 14-4
Determine facial shapes.

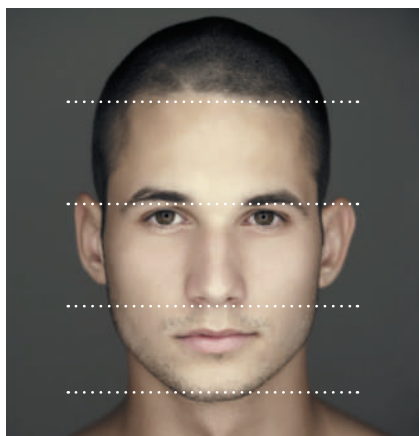


figure 14-5
Oval face shape.



figure 14-6
Round.



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To determine a facial shape, divide the face into three zones: forehead to eyebrows, eyebrows to end of nose, and end of nose to chin (**Figure 14-4**). Envision these divisions while reviewing the following facial shapes.

Oval. The oval-shaped face is generally recognized as the ideal shape.

- Any hairstyle that maintains the oval shape is usually suitable.
- Change the part or redirect the hair to experiment with different looks (**Figure 14-5**).

Round. The aim here is to slim the face.

- Hair that is too short will emphasize the fullness of the face.
- Create some height on the top to lengthen the look of the face.
- An off-center part and some waves at eye level will also help lessen the full appearance of the face.
- Beards should be styled to make the face appear more oval (**Figure 14-6**).

Inverted triangular. This facial shape has over-wide cheekbones and a narrow jawline.

- Keep the hair close at the crown and temples and longer in back.
- Try changing the part and the direction of the hair.
- A full beard helps to fill out the narrow jaw (**Figure 14-7**).

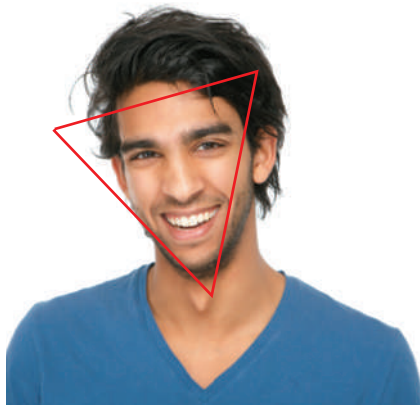
Square. This shape has angular features at the forehead and jaw.

- Use wavy bangs that blend into the temples to an asymmetrical line.
- Minimize the square look by directing more hair to the temple areas.
- Beards should be styled to slenderize the face (**Figure 14-8**).

Pear-shaped. This shape is narrow at the top and wide on the bottom.

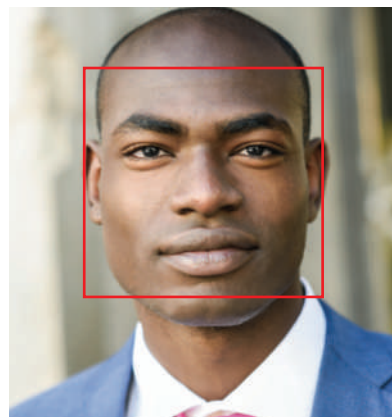
- Create width and fullness at the top, temples, and sides to produce balance.
- Short, full styles are best, ending just above the jawline where it joins the ear area.

figure 14-7
Inverted triangular.



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figure 14-8
Square.



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figure 14-9
Pear.

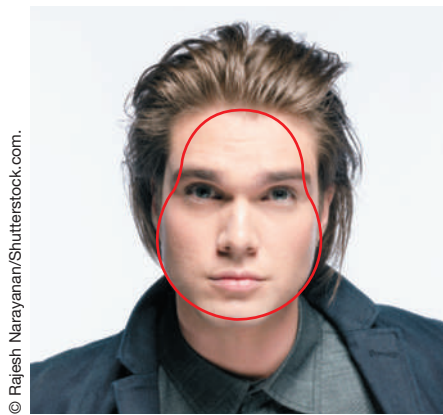


figure 14-10
Oblong.

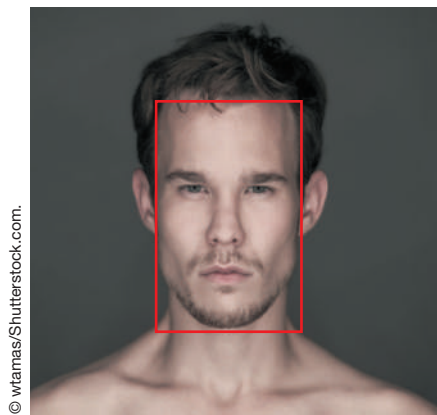
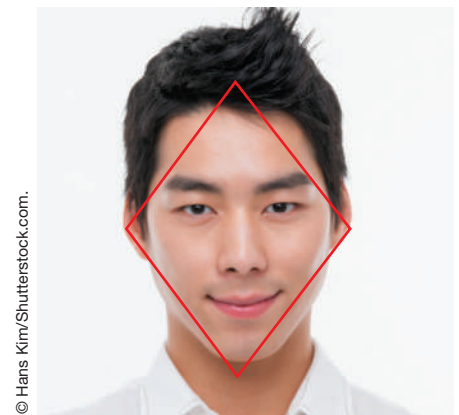


figure 14-11
Diamond.



- A body wave or medium-size curl perm is another way to achieve width at the top.
- Beards should be styled to slenderize the lower jaw area (**Figure 14-9**).

Oblong. The long face needs to be visually shortened and its angularity softened.

- Layered bangs brushed to the sides over the temples can camouflage the front hairline, giving the illusion of a shorter facial shape.
- Wearing a mustache also helps to shorten the look of a longer face shape (**Figure 14-10**).

Diamond. This face shape is narrow at the temples and chin.

- Create a style with width or fullness at the temples.
- Keep hair close to the head at the widest points of the face.
- Direct bangs off the face and into the sides to broaden the appearance of the forehead.
- A full, square, or rounded beard is also appropriate (**Figure 14-11**).

Head Shapes

Generally speaking, the basic shape of the head consists of rounded portions, such as the crown, parietal, and occipital areas; concave curved areas as found below the occipital to the nape; and portions of flat areas in the top and side sections. However, not every client's head shape conforms to this general description and that can create particular haircutting and styling challenges for the barber. For example, a head shape that is more pointed at the apex may require longer hair lengths between the temporal and top areas to create the illusion of roundness and evenness through that section. In other cases, the client might have one or more ridges of scalp through the occipital area, rather than a smooth curve to the nape area; leaving the hair slightly longer in this area can help camouflage the ridges while close cutting only makes them more visible. As a barber, you will see many variations of head shapes and these variations will influence the cutting techniques you use and the styles you recommend.

figure 14-12
Straight.



figure 14-13
Concave.



Profiles

You should be aware of your client's profile since it can influence the appropriateness of the haircut or style he wears. You will need to study the position, shape, and size of the forehead, nose, and chin from both side (profile) and full-face views to determine the best look for your client.

Straight profiles tend to be the most balanced and proportioned because the forehead and chin align with only a slight curvature; a variety of hairstyles are appropriate for this profile type (Figure 14-12).

Concave profiles have a prominent forehead and chin. Use a close hair arrangement at the forehead to minimize the bulge of the forehead (Figure 14-13).

Convex profiles recede at the forehead and chin. This profile can appear straighter by creating the appearance of balance from the forehead to the chin. Experiment with arranging the hair at the front hairline to add volume and suggest the client wear a beard or goatee; this will help to balance out the projection of the nose by adding bulk to the features that recede (Figure 14-14).

Angular profiles have a receding forehead, but the chin tends to jut forward. This profile can appear more balanced by arranging the hair over the forehead and by adding a mustache and a close-cut beard to minimize the look of the protruding chin (Figure 14-15).

Prominent nose shapes include a hooked nose, large nose, or pointed nose. Style the hair forward at the forehead and back on the sides to minimize the prominence of the nose; beards and mustaches can also be used to balance the features (Figure 14-16).

Small to average nose shapes usually require shorter haircut styles because the size or heavy features associated with prominent nose shapes are not an issue. Experiment with different part lines or by combing the hair in different directions on the sides (Figure 14-17).

Neck Lengths

The length of the client's neck is also a factor in determining the overall shape of the haircut and style. In most cases, it is advisable to follow the

figure 14-14
Convex.



figure 14-15
Angular.



figure 14-16
Prominent nose.



figure 14-17
Smaller nose.



client's natural hairline; however, sometimes an overly long or very short neck limits the options. You will have to consider the length of the hairline and the growth pattern and density of the hair at the nape to determine the most suitable design for your client. Review the following guidelines for working with different neck lengths:

- A long neck can appear shorter if the hair is left fuller or longer at the nape. Avoid cutting into or above the natural hairline as this will only make the neck appear longer (**Figure 14-18**).
- A short neck can appear longer if the hair does not extend below the natural hairline at the nape. Tapering this area and fine blending at the natural hairline will also help create the illusion of a longer neck (**Figure 14-19**).

Ear Size and Placement

The size and placement of the client's ears is important to a haircut design because these characteristics help to determine the most appropriate length or thickness for the hair at the sides of the client's head and for the length of his sideburns. For example, a client whose ears have a tendency to stick out might prefer a style that leaves the hair fuller on the sides or a style that covers the top of the ear. Either option will create the illusion of less distance between the client's ears and his head. The size and placement of the client's ears also influences his options for the length, thickness, and shape of his sideburns, as explained in the following section.

Sideburn Lengths and Designs

To determine the most suitable length and shape for the client's sideburns, you will need to consider his hairstyle, facial structure and features, natural hair growth, and the size and placement of his ears. Consider the relationships of these factors to sideburn designs, as discussed below.

The sideburns will look short, medium, or long relative to client's facial features and structure. For example, a 1-inch-long sideburn may appear short to medium on a client with a larger, longer facial structure or too long on a client with smaller or shorter facial features.

The client's natural hair growth is a consideration because it determines his natural hairline and the density and texture of his hair. These characteristics affect the amount of hair there is to work within the sideburn areas and the design options you will have to create a balanced and proportioned look. For example, if the client has light, thin sideburn hair, very close cutting can result in creating patches or exposing the underlying skin. Conversely, dark, thick sideburn hair may require very close cutting and tapering to reduce the appearance of weight and to create balance with the haircut.

Like his facial structure, the size and placement of the client's ears will determine if the sideburns are considered short, medium, or long relative to his particular features. For example, a short sideburn for a client with small features might be ½-inch long and a short sideburn for a client with larger features might be ¾-inch long.

figure 14-18
Long neck.

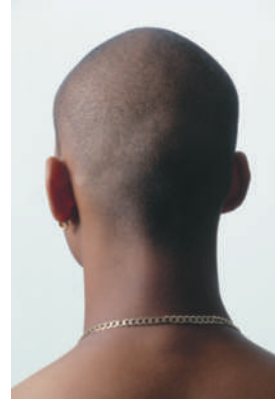


figure 14-19
Short neck.



figure 14-20
Sections of the head: side view.

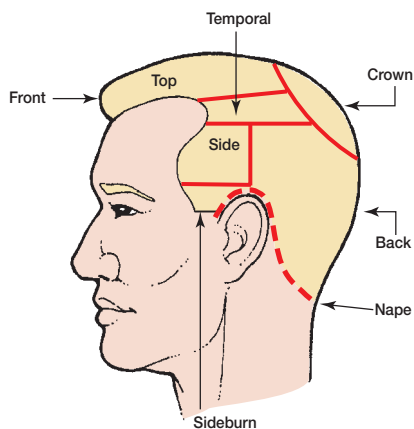


figure 14-21
Sections of the head: front view.

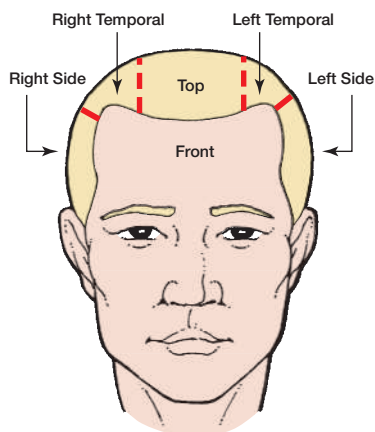
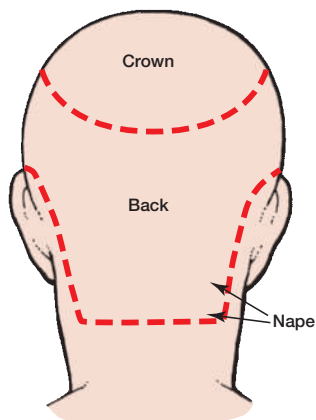


figure 14-22
Sections of the head: back view.



Some guidelines for designing sideburns are as follows:

- The length, shape, and density of the sideburns influence the look of the haircut and the client's facial features overall. Be aware of balance, color, and proportion when cutting in the sideburns.
- Sideburns should *appear* even in length and thickness when viewed from the front, preferably in a mirror.
- The density of the sideburns should blend gradually from the hairline into the side sections.
- Anatomical features, such as the facial bones, may be used as a general guide for trimming sideburns but it must be remembered that few people have truly symmetrical features. Therefore, a ½-inch-long sideburn on the right side might need to be slightly shorter or longer on the left side to appear even when viewing the client from the front.
- Sideburns should complement the facial shape and hairstyle.

LEARN THE SECTIONS OF THE HEAD FORM

To create consistent and successful results in haircutting, it is necessary to understand the shape of the head. Hair responds differently in different areas of the head because of the curves and changes from one section to the next. Visualizing the sections of the head form as presented in this textbook will help you to:

- Know where to start a haircut
- Develop patterns or steps for cutting specific styles
- Eliminate technical mistakes when blending from one section to another
- Reduce confusion when cutting because you will know where you are in the cut
- Facilitate easier checking of the final result

The sections of the head form as depicted in **Figures 14-20** through **14-22** include the

- Front
- Top (apex)
- Temporal (crest, parietal ridge, hatband, horseshoe)
- Crown (tonsure area)
- Sides
- Sideburns
- Back
- Nape

Reference points (REF-err-ence POYNTZ) are points on the head that mark areas where the surface of the head changes or the behavior of the hair changes as a result of the surface changes. These points are used to establish proportionate design lines and contours.

The **parietal ridge** (puh-RY-ate-uhl RIJ) is also known as the **crest** (KREST), *temporal*, *horseshoe*, or *hatband* area of the head. It is the widest section of the head, starting at the temples and ending just below the crown. When a comb is placed flat against the head at the sides, the parietal ridge begins where the head starts to curve away from the comb (Figure 14-23). The parietal ridge is one of the most important sections of the head when cutting hair because it serves as a transition area from the top to the front, sides, and back sections.

The occipital bone protrudes at the base of the skull. When a comb is placed flat against the nape area, the occipital begins where the head curves away from the comb (Figure 14-24). The apex is the highest point on the top of the head (Figure 14-25). The four corners are located by crossing two diagonal lines at the apex (Figure 14-26). The lines will point to the front and back corners of the head.

Tapering and Blending Areas

Taper (TAYP-uhr) or tapering is the action of gradually increasing the length of the hair from one point on the head to another without any lines of demarcation such as gaps or steps. The primary tapering areas of a cut are determined by the style. For example, in a standard taper cut, gradual tapering occurs from the hairline through the back and side sections up to the top; in the case of a bald fade, most of the tapering takes place around the parietal ridge. Tapering and blending areas refer to the sections or levels within the haircut where transitions between hair lengths occur.

Clients often describe their desired style in terms of length using such words as *long*, *medium*, *short*, *close* or *extra-short*, or *faded*. Tapering and

 **REMINDER**

The temporal section of the head is part of the *parietal ridge* and is also known as the *crest*, *horseshoe*, or *hatband* region of the head.

figure 14-23
The parietal ridge.

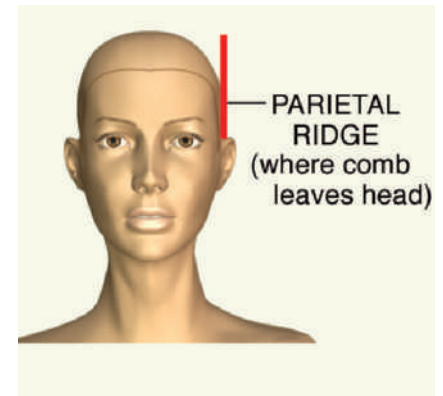


figure 14-24
The occipital bone.

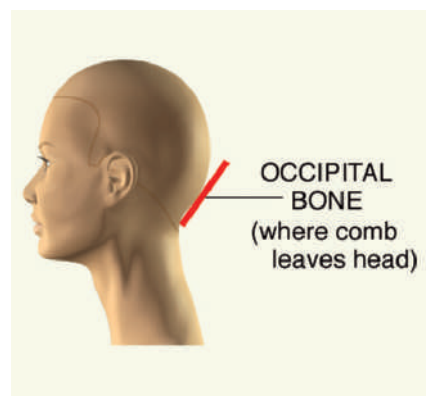


figure 14-25
The apex.

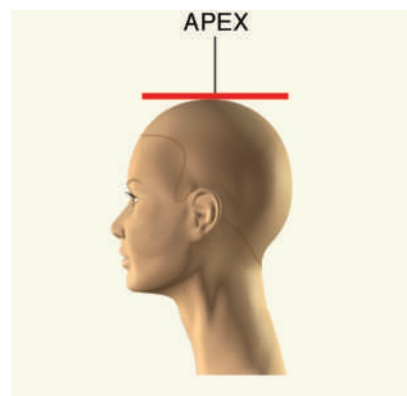
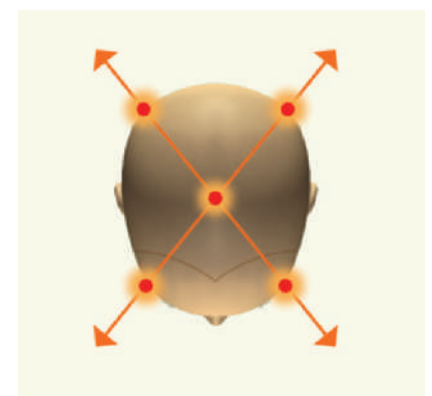


figure 14-26
The four corners.



blending areas for these basic lengths vary with the haircut design and the shape of the head.

With the exception of a bald fade or a bi-level cut, tapering begins at the nape and side hairlines (including the sideburns), as indicated by the bottom dashed lines in the figures. The top lines depict the highest point of the tapered area and indicate transition areas into longer hair. Sections between dashed lines show where the gradual tapering and blending takes place. Notice the relationship of the tapering and blending areas in relation to the curves of the head. Longer styles usually require the least amount of close tapering.

Tapering is performed from the nape hairline to just below the occipital and just above the bottom of the ear when seen from the back (Figure 14-27). If the ears are exposed, tapering on the sides begins at the hairline and connects with the taper behind the ear before blending into longer side and back lengths. Medium-length styles do not have a scalped appearance, although the hair is cut closer to the head than in longer, fuller styles (Figure 14-28). Closer tapering is performed from the nape hairline to the occipital at a point that is about even with the tops of the ears.

In the sideburn areas, tapering should blend into the side section at the tops of the ears. Semi-short styles are tapered slightly higher to above the occipital. The hair is tapered to the bottom of the parietal ridge in the back and side sections (Figure 14-29). Short or close styles usually require close tapering up to the bottom of the crest or at a level within the crest, ending at the curvature of the head in this area (Figure 14-30). Fade styles are cut extremely close in the back and lower side areas, become gradually longer in the crest, and are longest in the top section. Very close cutting, including balding when desired, is performed from the nape to the bottom of the parietal ridge. Sides are cut using the next larger clipper blade to blend through the parietal area. The next larger blade is used in the parietal area to blend with the top section (Figure 14-31). Hair is cut against the grain, across the grain, or with the grain depending on the hair texture and growth pattern in the section being cut.

figure 14-27

Taper area for longer hairstyles.

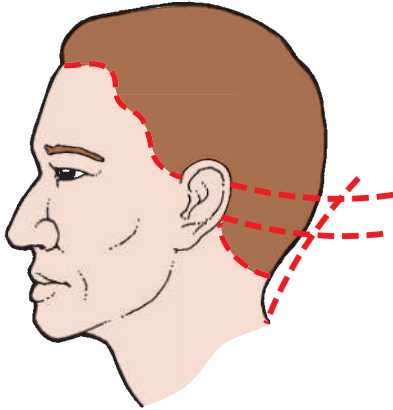


figure 14-28

Taper area for medium-length hairstyles.

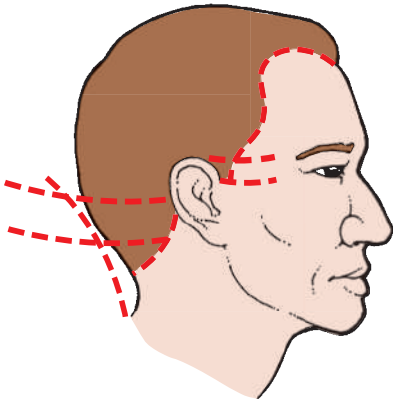


figure 14-29

Taper area for semi-short hairstyles.

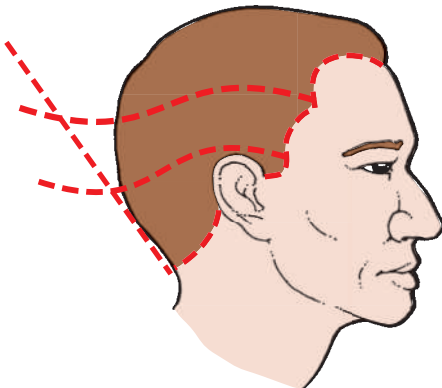


figure 14-30

Taper area for short hairstyles.

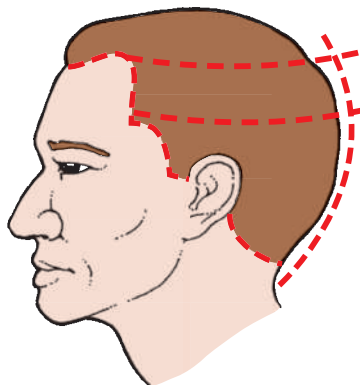
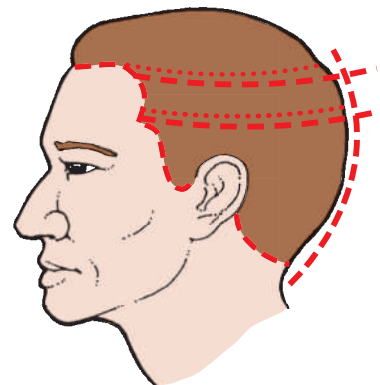


figure 14-31

Taper area for fade hairstyles.



UNDERSTAND DESIGN ELEMENTS USED IN HAIRCUTTING

Design is the foundation of all artistic applications and an understanding of its principles will help you develop a strong visual eye and the judgment needed to create successful designs for your clients. Barbers work with the three-dimensional design elements of line, form (shape), space, texture, and color.

Lines

A *line* is simply a series of connected dots that result in a continuous mark. Straight and curved lines are used in haircutting to create design, shape, and direction (Figure 14-32). *Curved* lines are either concave or convex in shape and may repeat, as in a wave pattern. The three types of *straight* lines used in haircutting are horizontal, vertical, and diagonal lines (Figure 14-33):

- **Horizontal lines** (hor-ih-ZAHN-tul LYNZ) are parallel to the horizon or floor and direct the eye from one side to the other.
 - *Horizontal cutting lines* build weight and are used to create a one-length look and low elevation or blunt haircut designs.
 - *Weight lines* are usually created at the perimeter or at the occipital area of a haircut (Figures 14-34 and 14-35).
- **Vertical lines** (VUR-tih-kuhl LYNZ) are perpendicular to the floor and are described in terms of up and down.
 - Vertical partings facilitate projecting the hair at higher elevations while cutting.
 - Vertical cutting lines remove weight within the cut and create layers.
 - Layers may be cut in from short to long, cut in from long to short, or cut uniformly depending on finger placement (Figure 14-36).



DID YOU KNOW?

State barber boards most often require practical-exam candidates to perform a taper cut because it requires several cutting techniques using different tools to perform properly. These techniques include fingers-and-shear, shear-over-comb, freehand shear/freehand clipper, clipper-over-comb, and razor outlining.

figure 14-32
Lines and angles.

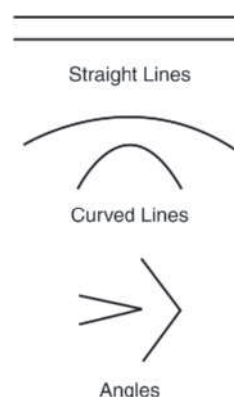


figure 14-33
Horizontal, vertical, and diagonal lines.

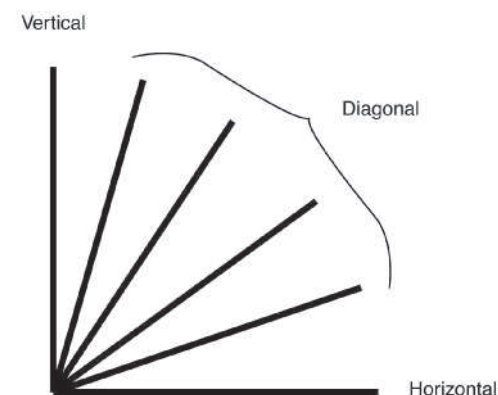


figure 14-34
Weight line at perimeter.

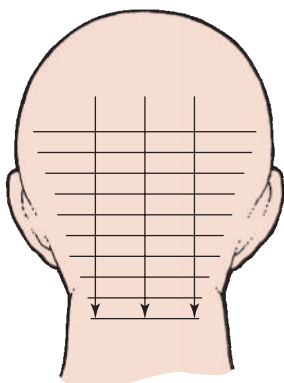


figure 14-35
Weight line at occipital.

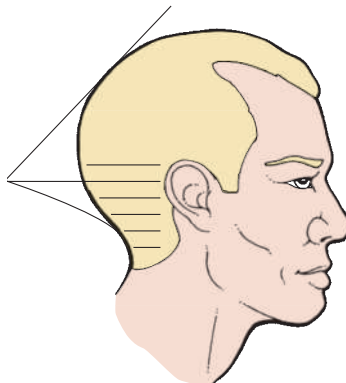


figure 14-36
Vertical partings facilitate layering.

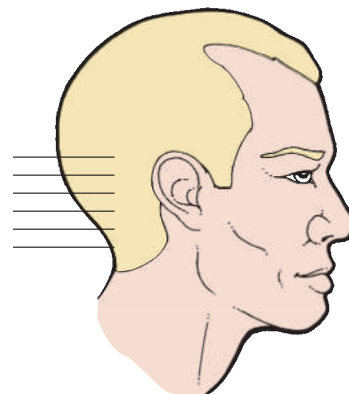
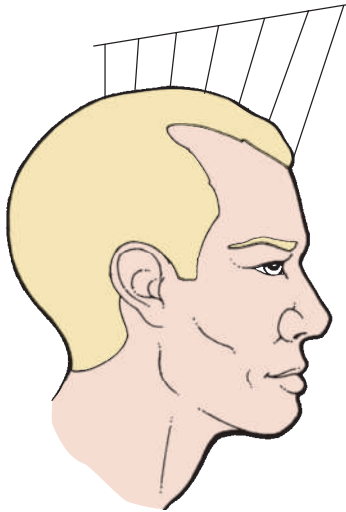


figure 14-37

Diagonal line within top front sections.



- **Diagonal lines** (dye-AG-ih-nul LYNZ) have a slanted direction and are used to create sloped lines within a haircut or at the perimeter to determine the design line (Figure 14-37).
 - When used at the perimeter, these lines are referred to as *diagonal forward* or *diagonal back*.
 - When used in the top section of a haircut design, a diagonal line produces increased length at one end and slopes down to a shorter length at the opposite end.
 - *Diagonal finger placement* may also be used to create a stacked, layered effect at the perimeter or to blend longer layers to shorter layers within a haircut.
- **Curved lines** (KURVD LYNZ) move in a semicircular or circular direction and can be shallow or deep. Curved lines soften a design and can be placed horizontally, vertically, or diagonally; when repeated in opposite directions, they create a wave pattern. The rounded portion of a concave line curves inward and the rounded portion of a convex line curves outward.
 - Concave and convex lines are often used at the perimeter of a hair design in the nape or back area and around the face.
 - Cutting the nape or back area into a rounded shape with the curve at the bottom of the design produces a convex line.
 - Cutting the nape area into a rounded shape with the curve at the top of the design and the ends of the curve ending at the corners of the nape produces a concave line (refer to Figure 14-32).

Form

Form (FORM) is the outline or shape of a hairstyle. The elements of width, length, and depth create a three-dimensional shape that can vary in terms of volume, proportion, and balance. Hairstyles should be proportionate to the client's overall body shape and size and balance with the features of his head, face, and neck.

- **Proportion** (pruh-POR-shun) measures or shows the comparative relationship between two or more design elements of a form. These elements influence the visual proportion of one section of the head form to another or between the head form and the facial features and/or the body. For example, if a client has a long neck and you shorten the natural hairline in the nape too high on the back of the head, the haircut will look out of proportion or *disproportionate* to the client's neck length and appear unbalanced.
- **Balance** (BAL-uns) is the equal or appropriate proportions that create symmetry and harmony in a design. Balance can be symmetrical or asymmetrical depending on the cutting lines and the ratio of length to width in the overall shape of the style. Hair density is an important design element when discussing balance because differences in the thickness of the hair can make one side appear heavier than the other and create an unbalanced or unfinished look.

Space

As it relates to art and design elements, space is considered either positive or negative. In hair design, the form (haircut or style) occupies *positive space* and the area that surrounds it is *negative space*. Barbers are usually more aware of the positive space (form) than the negative space; however, it is the negative space that brings the positive space into sharp focus. For example, when you face a client toward the mirror to check your work, his haircut (form) occupies positive space and the background you see in the mirror becomes negative space, allowing you to see areas of the form that need adjusting when checking for balance and proportion.

Design Texture

Design texture refers to the quality of a form's surface. Is the surface shiny or dull? Rough or smooth? Straight or wavy or curly? These conditions impact the degree to which light reflects off the surface of the hair and therefore affects the image or form we see. For example, wavy hair may appear to have light areas at the top (crest) of the wave and dark areas in the bottom (trough) of the wave, which may need special blending to appear more uniform in a close-cut hairstyle.

Color

Like texture, different colors reflect light differently. Dark colors tend to recede in a design and lighter colors appear to come to the foreground. These color differences create the illusions of more or less depth and volume in a form.

UNDERSTAND BASIC TERMINOLOGY USED IN HAIRCUTTING AND STYLING

Angles

An **angle** (ANG-gul) is the space between two lines or surfaces that intersect at a given point. Angles help to create strong, consistent foundations in hair-cutting and are used in two ways.

- *Angles* can refer to the degree of elevation at which the hair is held for cutting—a typical instruction, for example, would be “angle the hair section at a 45-degree projection from the head.”
- *Angles* can also refer to the position of the fingers when cutting a section of hair (cutting line), as in “using a vertical parting, angle the fingers 45 degrees from the hairline to the occipital.”

Directional Terms

Directional terms used in haircutting typically refer to how the tool is used relative to the direction of the way the hair grows.

- Cutting *against the grain* means to cut the hair in the opposite direction from which it grows.

figure 14-38

Elevations relative to the head form.

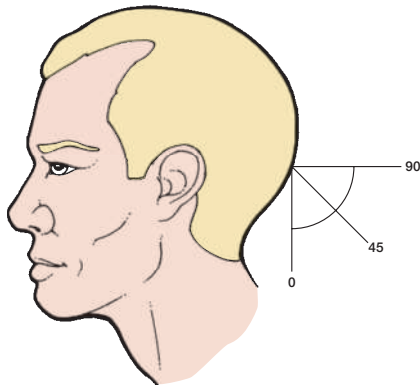


figure 14-39

Horizontal, zero elevation.

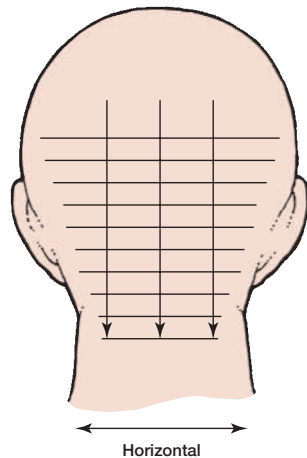
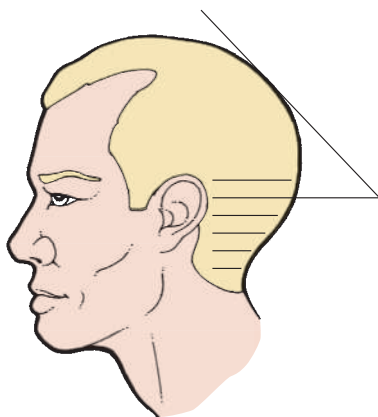


figure 14-40

Horizontal, 45-degree elevation.



- Cutting *with the grain* is cutting the hair in the same direction in which it grows.
- Cutting *across the grain* means the hair is cut in a direction that is neither with nor against the grain.
- Cutting with a circular motion may be required in whorl areas, where the hair does not grow in a uniform manner.

Cross-checking

Cross-checking (KRAWS-CHEK-ing) is the process of parting off subsections opposite from the elevation or direction at which they were cut to check the precision of cutting lines or blending. For example, a vertical subsection cut at a 90-degree projection can be cross-checked by parting off the subsections horizontally at 90 degrees.

Elevation and Projection

Elevation (el-uh-VAY-shun) is the angle or degree at which a section of hair is held from the head for cutting, *relative from where it grows*. Elevation, also known as **projection** (pruh-JEK-shun), is the result of lifting the hair section above 0 elevation, or natural fall. This projection of the hair while cutting produces graduation or layers and is usually described in terms of degrees (Figure 14-38).

- 0 elevation is the lowest elevation and produces weight, bulk, and maximum length at the perimeter of a hair design.
- 0 elevation is achieved by combing the hair straight down from where it grows and cutting it either against the skin (as in the nape or around-the-ear area) or as it is held straight down between the fingers to create the perimeter or design line (Figure 14-39).
- The design line serves as a guide for all subsequent partings that will be brought to the perimeter for cutting.
- 0-elevation cutting creates crisp, clean lines at the hairline on shorter hairstyles and achieves the standard *blunt cut* on longer hair.
- Holding the hair at 45 degrees from where it grows is considered to be a *medium elevation*.
 - *Medium elevation*, or *graduation*, creates layered ends, or *stacking*, within the parting of hair from the 0-elevation distance to the 45-degree position. Movement and texture are created within the distance between the two degrees, depending on the length of the hair and the position of the angle in relation to the head form.
- A horizontal parting and stationary guide at the perimeter is used to achieve the graduated or stacked effect (Figure 14-40).
- Graduation can also be achieved by using a vertical parting projected at 45 degrees, with a diagonal finger placement of 45 degrees (Figure 14-41).
- A 90-degree elevation is the most common projection used in men's hair-cutting and is considered to be a high elevation.

- A 90-degree elevation produces layering, tapering, and blended effects.
- When using a 90-degree elevation, the hair is held straight out from the head *from where it grows*.
- Either vertical and horizontal partings are used depending on the section of the head form being cut.
- A 90-degree elevation requires a traveling guide in order to move around and over the curves of the entire head.
- Lengths in various sections of the head form can vary, but the hair should still be blended overall.

A 90-degree elevation is used to create uniform layers in which each hair section is cut to the same length (Figure 14-42a) or to perform a taper that is shorter at the hairline and increasingly longer toward the top (Figure 14-42b).

- Compare Figures 14-42a and 14-42b. In both cases the hair is positioned at 90 degrees using vertical partings in the back section. However, to create a tapered effect, the fingers, and therefore the cutting line, are positioned at a 45-degree angle to allow closer cutting to the head form in the nape area.
- If the haircut is started at the nape, the fingers will be positioned at a 45-degree angle from the hairline and will be gradually repositioned to a perpendicular position and then beyond a perpendicular as the hair is cut and blended over the curve of the head to the top section.

An elevation of *180 degrees* is often used to create layers when cutting long hair. A 90-degree stationary guide is used, usually in the top section, and the longer hair on the sides and back are elevated to the guide for cutting. It is important to remember that the hair being cut is at a 180-degree elevation, not the stationary guide. Refer to Chapter 16: Women's Haircutting and Styling.

A **part** (PART) is a line, created naturally or with a comb, that divides the hair at the scalp, separating one section of the hair from another. The position and direction of a *natural part* is determined by the direction or slant the hair takes as it leaves the follicle.

A client's natural part can easily be determined by combing clean, damp hair back toward the crown and then gently pushing the section forward: where the hair splits and falls to either side reveals the natural part. A *hard part* is created during the finishing steps of a haircut by shaving the scalp area of a natural or styled part line in the hair.

A **parting** (PART-ing), or subsection, is a smaller section of hair that is parted off from a larger section of hair.

- The use of partings is essential to maintain control of the hair in manageable proportions and to perform precision cutting.
- The direction of the parting line at the scalp should be consistent with the intended cutting line.
- Partings may be horizontal, vertical, or diagonal.

figure 14-41

Vertical parting with 45-degree angle.

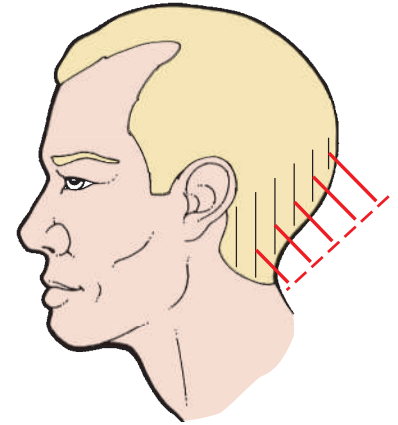


figure 14-42a

Uniform 90-degree layers.

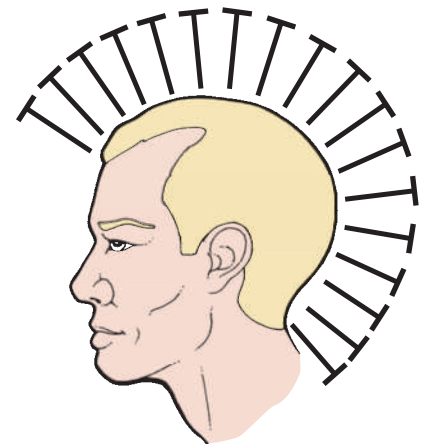


figure 14-42b

90-degree taper.

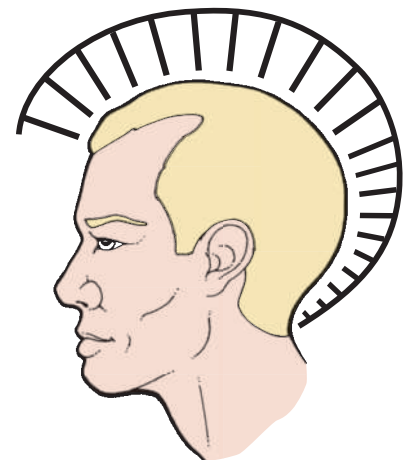


figure 14-43
Horizontal blunt cut design line.



figure 14-44
Stationary guide.

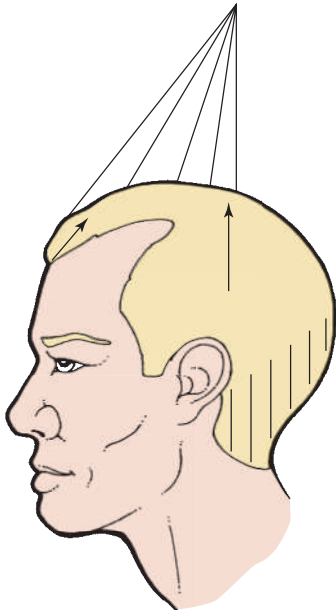


figure 14-45
Following the traveling guide.



- Partings are held horizontally, vertically, or diagonally, with a usual elevation range of 0 to 180 degrees.
- The way a parting is sectioned off from a larger section and projected for cutting determines the end result.
- Layering within a haircut is usually achieved using $\frac{1}{4}$ -inch to $\frac{1}{2}$ -inch partings.

The **cutting line** (KUT-ing LYN) is established by the angle of the fingers or comb when securing a section of hair for cutting. Cutting lines are horizontal, vertical, or diagonal based on the position of the fingers or tool.

- The cutting tool used will follow the position and angle of the fingers or comb when cutting.
- Finger or comb placement should be checked before cutting to avoid
 - cutting in an unwanted line design (such as diagonal rather than horizontal);
 - losing the guide;
 - cutting off too much hair.

The **design line** (dee-ZYN LYN) is the outer perimeter line of the haircut. It may act as a guide depending on the overall design of the haircut and the method the barber uses to achieve it. A design line can be seen in the hanging length of a blunt cut or along the hairline of a short cut, wherever the perimeter of the haircut is located (**Figure 14-43**).

A **guide** (GUYD), also known as a *guideline* or *guide strand*, is a cut that is made by which subsequent partings or sections of hair will be measured and cut.

- Guides are classified as being either stationary or traveling.
- Both types of guides may originate at the outer perimeter (design line) of the hair or at an interior section such as the crown area.
- Most haircuts are achieved by using a combination of the two types of guides.
- A **stationary guide** (STAY-shun-ar-ee GUYD) is used for
 - achieving overall one-length-looking designs at the perimeter (blunt cut);
 - maintaining the length of a section while subsequent partings are brought from other sections to meet it for cutting; this produces either an overall longlayered effect or extra length within a section (**Figure 14-44**).
- A **traveling guide** (TRAV-ell-ing GUYD) moves along a section of hair as each cut is made **Figure 14-45**. Once the length of the initial guide has been cut, a parting is taken from in front of it or near it, combed with the original guide, and cut. Then a new parting is taken, combed with the second parting of hair, and cut against that guide. It is this use of the previous guide to cut a subsequent parting of hair that makes it a traveling guide.
 - Care must be taken not to recut the original or subsequent guides as you move along the section to cut a new parting.
 - When performed correctly, a traveling guide ensures even layering and blending of the hair from one section to another.

Layers (LAY-uhz) are produced by elevating the hair beyond zero elevation for cutting.

- Layers can originate from the front, top (apex), crown, or perimeter (usually the design line).
- Layering can be angled (shorter on top and longer at the perimeter), uniform (even throughout), or fully tapered (longer on top and shorter at the perimeter).
- Layering is used to blend, to create fullness, or to create movement or texture in the hair.

A **taper** (TAYP-uh), or *tapering*, means that the hair conforms to the shape of the head.

- The hair is shorter at the nape and hairline and longer in the crown and top areas.
- Most men's haircuts require some form of tapering.
- Blending of all of the hair lengths is extremely important.

A **weight line** (WAYT LYN) refers to the heaviest perimeter area of a 0-elevation or 45-degree cut.

- A weight line is achieved by using a stationary guide at the perimeter and may be cut in at a variety of levels on the head, depending on the style.
- Weight lines can be used in combination with a tapered nape area.
- The perimeter is the weight line in longer hairstyles that *look* to be one length.

Texturizing (TEKS-chur-yz-ing) is usually performed after the overall cut has been completed to create special effects such as wispy or spiky strands within the haircut or along the perimeter.

Tension (TEN-shun) is the amount of pressure applied while combing and holding a section of hair for cutting.

- Tension ranges from minimum to maximum, as a result of the amount of stretching employed when holding the hair between the fingers.
- The spacing between the teeth of the comb also influences the amount of tension you will be able to achieve when combing the hair. This is because the spacing between the teeth allows for more or less movement in the hair; for example, a fine-toothed comb facilitates more tension than a wide-toothed comb because the hair has less room to move or shift while the combing takes place.
- Use maximum tension on straight hair to create precise lines.
- Use minimal to moderate tension on curly and wavy hair as the hair may dry shorter than intended if maximum tension is used.

Thinning (THIN-ing) refers to removing excess bulk from the hair.

Outlining (OWT-lyn-ing) means marking the outer perimeter of the haircut in front of and around the ears and at the sides and nape of the neck; outlining at the front hairline is optional, depending on hair texture.

Overdirection (OH-ver-dih-REK-shun) creates a length increase in the design and occurs when the hair is combed away from its natural fall position rather than straight out from the head toward a guide.

Hairstyling (HAYR-sti-hyl-ing) is the art of arranging the hair in a particular style that is appropriately suited to the cut. Hairstyling may involve the use of styling aids such as hair spray, gel, tonic, oil sheen, pomade, or mousse; appliances in the form of blowdryers or irons; and implements such as brushes, combs, and clips.

A Word about Terminology

During the course of your barbering career, you will be introduced to a variety of haircutting terms. Terminology for the most part depends on who is presenting the information or technique and whether or not new terms have replaced formerly used terms. For example, *parting* and *subsection* are terms that are often used interchangeably.

Here are some important things to remember about terminology used in haircutting and styling:

- There are only so many angles and elevations that can be used in haircutting.
- Specific effects are created by using specific angles and elevations.
- History has a way of repeating itself in our industry and style trends tend to be cyclical in nature. For example, crew cuts and box fades can be traced back to the years of World War II, finger waves were a hit in the 1920s and 1930s, and braiding has probably been around since humans first walked the earth.
- Design variations occur when a new spin or twist is incorporated into a basic cut or style.

These examples simply reinforce why it is important that you become proficient in the basic skills, which will enable you to adapt to whatever the current terminology or trend might be.

Describe Haircutting Techniques

After reading this section, you will be able to:

LO 7

Explain basic cutting techniques using shears, clippers, and razors.

In Chapter 5, you were introduced to the correct holding positions for the comb, shears, clippers, and razor. The terms used to describe how we use these basic tools are *fingers-and-shear*, *shear-over-comb*, *freehand shear cutting*, *freehand clipper cutting*, *clipper-over-comb*, *razor-over-comb*, and *razor rotation*. It is important to note that most haircutting procedures require a combination of techniques and tools. The most important factors that determine the tools used to achieve the haircut are the client's desired outcome, the texture and density of the hair, and the barber's personal preference. As a professional barber you should be comfortable and skillful using all the tools of the trade.

IDENTIFY SHEAR CUTTING TECHNIQUES

The primary shear cutting techniques used in barbering are fingers-and-shear, shear-over-comb, shear-point tapering, and freehand shear cutting. Other shear techniques are used for texturizing or removing bulk in the hair (see Hair Thinning and Texturizing later in this chapter).

Fingers-and-Shear Cutting

The **fingers-and-shear** (FING-erz-AND-SHEER) technique may be used on many hair types, from straight to curly. The three basic methods for using fingers-and-shear techniques are cutting on top of the fingers, cutting below the fingers, and cutting palm-to-palm. Refer to Procedure 14-1 for fingers-and-shear cutting techniques.

P 14-1 Fingers-and-Shear Cutting Techniques pages 422–423

- **Cutting above the fingers** (KUT-ing AH-bov THE FING-erz) is frequently used in men's haircutting to cut and blend layers in the top, crown, and horseshoe areas (see **Figure 14-46**). It is also used when cutting hair that is held out at a 90-degree elevation from a vertical parting, such as at the sides and back of the head form. Whether your finger position is perpendicular to the floor or angled at 45 degrees in these sections, the cutting should be performed on the outside (above) the fingers.
- **Cutting below the fingers** (KUT-ing BE-low THE FING-erz) is most often used to create design lines at the perimeter of the haircut (see **Figure 14-47**).
- **Cutting palm-to-palm** may be preferred by some practitioners. Care must be taken not to bend the hair or to project it higher than intended from the head form when using this technique. Also remember that the shears follow finger placement, so avoid curling the fingers inward when cutting unless you want a curved cutting line (**Figure 14-48**).

Shear-over-Comb Cutting

The **shear-over-comb** (SHEER-OH-ver-KOHM) technique is used to cut the ends of the hair and is an important method used in tapering. The comb is used to put the hair in a position to be cut and acts similarly to holding a section of hair between the fingers.

Most shear-over-comb cutting is performed in the nape, behind the ears, around the ears, and in the sideburn areas of a cut; however, an entire haircut can also be accomplished using this method.

Following are a few important guidelines for performing the shear-over-comb technique:

- Use vertical working panels when cutting back and side sections. Make sure panels overlap for better blending and to avoid missing sections of hair that need to be cut.
- After your first cut, make sure you can see the guide so you know where to cut to or cut from next.
- Use a diagonal comb placement when cutting areas behind and around the ears.

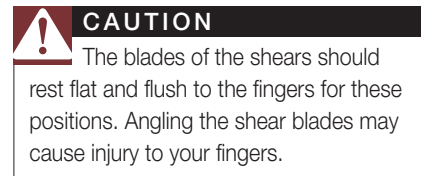


figure 14-46
Cutting above the fingers.



figure 14-47
Cutting below the fingers.



figure 14-48
Cutting palm-to-palm.

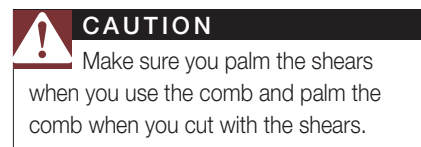


figure 14-49
Hold the comb and shears properly.



figure 14-50
Open and close the shears in tandem with an upward movement of the comb.



figure 14-51
Roll the comb using a key-turning motion.



DID YOU KNOW?
Traditionally, men's hair is not sectioned off with a hair clip unless the length of the hair warrants it. When working with long hair, there are three areas where a hair clip may be necessary to hold some of the hair out the way while cutting: the top section, at the sides, and at the nape when cutting in a design line.

figure 14-52
Position the hair to be cut by rolling the comb out.



figure 14-53
Cut to center guide.



Take some time and practice the following exercises to help you master shear-over-comb cutting. You can practice in front of a mirror or facing a partner.

- Position the comb and shears parallel to each other. Practice aligning the still blade of the shears with the comb at the level where the teeth join the back of the comb (**Figure 14-49**).
- Move the comb upward, opening and closing the shears simultaneously with the movement of the comb (**Figure 14-50**).
- After several cutting movements, use a key-turning motion to roll the teeth of the comb away from you, as if you were combing through hair (**Figure 14-51**).

Once you have become comfortable with the exercises you can begin practicing on your mannequin.

- Start at the hairline in the center of the nape area.
- With the teeth of the comb pointing upward, comb into a section of hair at the hairline, rolling the comb out toward you. The hair should protrude from the teeth of the comb and be in a position for cutting. This is called **rolling the comb out** (ROHL-ing THE KOHM OUT) (**Figure 14-52**).
- Simultaneously move the shears and the comb through the center panel, cutting the hair in the process. Stop at the occipital area and comb the hair down toward the hairline.
- Begin the next panel by including some hair from the center section with the hair to the right or left of center. There should now be two lengths of hair in the comb: shorter hair from the center section and longer hair from the second section. The shorter hair from the center section becomes the guide for the second panel (**Figure 14-53**).
- Finish one vertical strip at a time before proceeding with the next section.
- The shear-over-comb technique is also used in **shear-point tapering** (SHEER-POYNT TAYP-uh-ring) to thin out or customize difficult areas caused by hollows, wrinkles, whorls, or creases in the scalp. Dark and ragged hair patches can be minimized using the shear-point tapering technique, which uses the points of the shears to cut a few strands of hair at a time until the spot becomes less noticeable and blends in with the surrounding hair or hairline (**Figure 14-54**).

figure 14-54
Shear-point taper in the nape area.



figure 14-55
A comb can still be used to control hair for freehand cutting.



figure 14-56
Fine-tuning with freehand cutting.



Freehand Shear Cutting

Freehand shear cutting (FREE-HAND SHEER KUT-ing) is a technique that may or may not utilize your fingers or a comb to control the hair while cutting against the skin. This will depend on your personal preference and the type of free-hand cutting being performed. For example, combing a section of hair down and cutting against the skin is a form of freehand shear cutting (**Figure 14-55**); however, you may prefer to use the comb to control the hair section against the client's skin. A second method of freehand shear cutting is to consistently open and close the shears as you skim over the surface of the hair to cut any stray hairs protruding from the design. This technique can be used in the final stages of a haircut, beard trim, or other procedure to fine-tune your work and is especially effective for shaping or trimming tight curl textures (**Figure 14-56**).

IDENTIFY CLIPPER CUTTING TECHNIQUES

Clippers are versatile tools that can be used in several ways to cut a variety of hair textures and styles. The standard techniques are **freehand clipper cutting** (FREE-HAND KLIP-ur KUT-ing) and **clipper-over-comb** (KLIP-uhr-OH-ver-KOHM) cutting; however, you can also use clippers as you would shears to cut hair that is held between your fingers. This cutting method creates more texture in the hair ends than the blunt ends that shears produce. As a general rule, clipper cutting is followed up with shear-and-comb work to fine-tune the haircut and/or to perform arching or outline work.

Cutting and tapering the hair with clippers can be accomplished by cutting with the grain, against the grain, or across the grain. Compare the directions of hair growth and tool usage in **Table 14-1**.

Freehand Clipper Cutting

Freehand clipper cutting requires a steady hand and consistent use of the comb or hair pick while cutting. The use of the comb or pick is important because both implements are used to put the hair into a position to be cut and help to remove the excess hair cut from the previous section. This will provide you with a clearer view of the cutting results and any areas that may need reblending or cutting.

True freehand clipper cutting techniques tend to be used on two extremes of hair length.

table 14-1

DIRECTIONS OF HAIR GROWTH AND TOOL USAGE

Term	Action	Illustration
Cutting <i>with</i> the grain	Cut in the same direction of hair growth	
Cutting <i>against</i> the grain	Cut in the opposite direction of hair growth	
Cutting <i>across</i> the grain	Cut neither with nor against hair growth in transition areas	



STATE REGULATORY ALERT!

Freehand clipper cutting, clipper-over-comb, and fingers-and-shear work are techniques that are frequently combined to perform a single haircut.



STATE REGULATORY ALERT!

The use of guards is not considered to be a form of freehand clipper cutting; nor is this technique usually acceptable for state board practical examinations.

- They are used for very short, straight, wavy, and curly lengths in which little clipper-over-comb work is performed.
- For short hairstyles, detachable blade sizes generally range from size 0000 (close to shaving) to size 3½, which leaves the hair approximately ¾ inch long. Some manufacturers now have 00000 blade sizes as well.
- Freehand clipper cutting techniques are used for longer, tightly curled hair lengths that require more sculpting.
- Used for cutting tightly curled hair when a natural look is desired. The hair is picked out and put into position for cutting.
- A keen eye for balance, shape, and proportion is important when sculpting the hair into shape.

figure 14-57

Lightly guide the clipper upward from the hairline into the hair about an inch above the hairline.



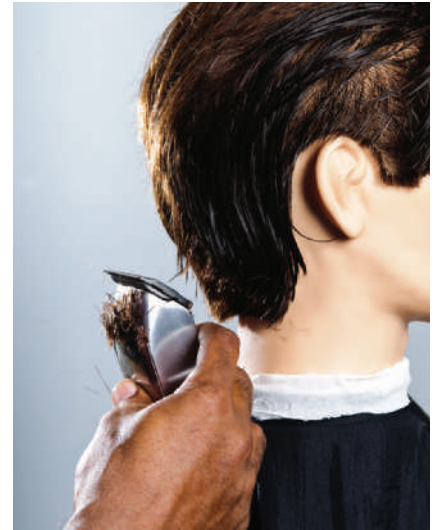
figure 14-58

Guide the blades through the ends of the hair.



figure 14-59

Remove the hair at lower nape area.



The freehand method is also used to taper hairlines at the nape, back, and sides. Refer to the following guidelines when practicing freehand clipper cutting. Remember to practice on a mannequin first.

- Start in the center nape area with the blades open.
- Gradually tilt the blade away from the head so the clipper rides on the heel of the bottom blade.
- Glide the clipper upward into the hair to about an inch above the hairline (Figure 14-57).
- Roll the clipper out as the blades cut through the ends of the hair (Figure 14-58).
- Note the removal of hair in the lower nape area (Figure 14-59).

Clipper-over-Comb Cutting

Clipper-over-comb cutting can be used for the entire haircut or to blend the hair from shorter tapered areas to longer areas at the top, crest, or occipital. Much like the shear-over-comb technique, the comb places the hair in a position to be cut and utilizes the same blending principles.

Refer to the following guidelines when practicing clipper-over-comb cutting; always remember to practice on a mannequin first.

- Begin in the back section and comb the hair down.
- Roll the comb out to put the hair in a position to be cut (Figure 14-60).
- Cut across the hair ends protruding from the comb with the clipper.

Arching with a Clipper or Trimmer

Many barbers prefer to use an outliner or trimmer with a fine cutting edge to finish sideburns and the outline around the ears and down the sides of the neck. This method of arching is efficient and precise due to the maneuverability of the smaller cutting head of the tool. If the desired result can

DID YOU KNOW?

Detachable blades should not be confused with clipper attachment combs, most commonly known as *guards*. Guards are placed on top of a clipper blade, allowing for more hair length to remain while cutting.

figure 14-60

Roll the comb out to position hair for the clipper.



REMINDER

When using the clipper-over-comb technique to taper, be sure to tilt the comb away from the head to create a blended taper from shorter to longer sections.

figure 14-61
Cutting using the razor-over-comb technique.



figure 14-62
Razor rotation involves a two-part continuous movement.



figure 14-63
Cutting using the fingers-and-razor technique.



CAUTION

The use of a razor with a safety guard is recommended for the beginner.

be accomplished with a standard clipper, that method is equally acceptable. Refer to Procedures 14-2 and 14-3 for guidelines on arching techniques and the outline shave.

P 14-2 Arching Techniques *pages 424–427*

P 14-3 Outline Shave *pages 428–430*

RAZOR CUTTING

Razor cutting is another method used by barbers to cut or texturize the hair. The angle of the razor relative to the surface of the hair tapers the hair ends rather than the blunt ends produced by shear cutting. This advantage makes razor cutting an effective option for blending, softening, shortening, or releasing weight from the hair strands during a cut.

The basic razor cutting techniques are razor-rotation, razor-over-comb, and fingers-and-razor cutting. The hair sections being cut need to be kept uniformly damp to ensure that the blade cuts through the hair smoothly without pulling or snagging; dry cutting is uncomfortable for the client and can frizz the hair surface.

Razor Cutting Techniques

Razor-over-comb (RAY-zur-OH-ver-KOHM) cutting can be performed in two different ways using a freehand razor position. The first method is similar to shear- or clipper-over-comb cutting, where “rolling the comb out” projects the hair ends into position for cutting and vertical or diagonal razor strokes are used across the comb to remove length. The second method involves positioning the razor horizontally on top of the comb to cut the hair that extends through the teeth of the comb with short, precise strokes and medium pressure (**Figure 14-61**). This second method is often used to blend and taper sections or to soften weight lines.

Razor rotation (RAY-zur row-TAY-shun) is performed by using a rotating motion with the comb and razor as the hair is being cut. In the first movement, the razor follows the comb through the hair. In the second movement, the comb follows the razor and so on to taper, blend, thin, or remove weight (**Figure 14-62**). This method requires coordinated razor stroking and combing actions to maintain continuous movements through the hair.

Fingers-and-razor cutting (FING-erz-AND-RAY-zur KUT-ing) is performed by holding the hair section between your fingers and cutting either from the top to the bottom of the section or from one side to the other. This method can be used on vertically or horizontally parted sections to remove length, taper ends, or reduce weight in mid-shaft sections. Also known as **freehand slicing** (FREE-HAND sly-SING) with razor, this technique can be used to create more movement within a style or to soften perimeters (**Figure 14-63**).

Razor Strokes

Some barbers consider razor cutting to be the best method for tapering and blending the hair because the razor edge permits a smoother blend

than what can be achieved with shears or clippers. When razor cutting a section, the cutting technique and angle of the razor strokes you use will determine how much hair is removed from the hair strands. It is important that you learn how to coordinate your razor and comb. A general rule is to taper a little at a time to avoid removing too much hair. Consider the following taper-blending methods used to achieve different effects.

- In *light taper-blending* the razor is held almost flat against the surface of the hair. Note the small amount of hair that is cut when the blade is only slightly tilted and very little pressure is used (Figure 14-64).
- *Heavier taper-blending* is performed with the razor held up to 45 degrees from the surface of the hair strand. As the razor is tilted higher and a little more pressure is used, the depth of the cut increases (Figure 14-65).
- In *terminal blending* the angle of the razor blade is increased to almost 90 degrees; this produces the least amount of tapering to the hair ends (Figure 14-66).

Hair Textures and Razor Cutting

Some general guidelines to keep in mind when razor cutting different hair textures are as follows:

- Coarse, thick hair requires more strokes and heavier tapering than other textures to remove bulk.
- Medium-textured hair requires fewer razor strokes and lighter pressure than coarse, thick hair to blend or remove bulk; avoid overthinning the hair.
- Fine hair does not usually have any bulk to remove, although you might want to use the razor to create texture at the perimeter. Use a light stroke of the razor with very little pressure.

Razor Cutting Tips

- The hair must be clean and damp for best results and to avoid client discomfort. Maintain moisture content throughout the cut.
- Avoid tapering too close to the hair part or the scalp. Tapering the hair too closely to the hair part will cause the hair to stand up, making the part look ragged. Coarse hair that is cut too closely to the scalp will have short, stubby hair ends that can protrude through the top layer.
- Avoid over-tapering as it is difficult to correct a haircut after too much hair has been removed.

Razor Cutting Safety Precautions

- Handle the razor properly, keeping it closed whenever not in use.
- Be aware of the people around you when working with any sharp tool or implement.
 - A careless motion can cause injury to yourself or others.
 - Do not distract or startle anyone who is performing a service.

figure 14-64
Light taper-blending.

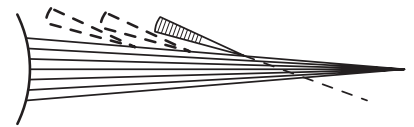


figure 14-65
Heavier taper-blending.

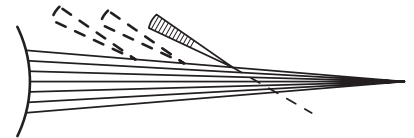
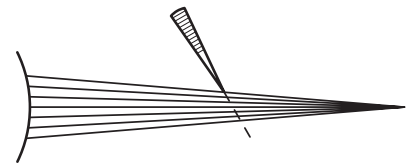


figure 14-66
Terminal blending.



- Purchase and use only good-quality haircutting implements.
- Use changeable-blade razors and dispose of used blades in a sharps container.
- Replace dull razor blades during the cut if necessary.
 - A dull blade will pull the hair and cause pain or discomfort to the client.
 - Dull blades will also decrease the quality of the haircut.

Hair Thinning and Texturizing

Hair thinning is used to reduce the bulk or weight of the hair. You can use thinning (serrated) shears, regular shears, clippers, or a razor for this purpose. Regardless of the tool used, some general rules to follow when removing bulk from the hair are as follows:

- Make a careful observation of the hair to determine the sections that require some reduction in bulk or weight and cut accordingly.
- Avoid cutting top surfaces of the hair where visible cutting lines can be seen.
- Part off and elevate the hair to be cut to avoid cutting too deeply into the section.
- Avoid cutting too closely to the scalp or part lines.

Removing Bulk

Review the following methods that can be used to reduce bulky or thick areas within a hair design.

- **Thinning.** When thinning with serrated shears, the hair parting is combed and held between the index and middle finger.
 - Place the serrated shears about mid-shaft on the strands and make a cut (**Figure 14-67**).
 - Make subsequent cuts at about 1 inch from the first cut.
 - Do not cut twice in the same place.
- **Slicing and carving.** There are two slicing methods that can be used to remove bulk with regular shears.
 - **Figure 14-68** shows the slicing technique performed on the surface of the hair.
 - **Figure 14-69** shows the carving technique performed by elevating the hair at 45 to 90 degrees and gliding the open shears through the hair with a curving motion. This removes hair from the under-portion of the parting as the motion is continued to the hair ends.
- **Slithering.** In this procedure a thin parting of hair is held between the fingers. The shears are positioned for cutting and an up-and-down sliding motion along the hair section is combined with a slight closing of the shears each time they are moved toward the scalp (**Figure 14-70**).

figure 14-67
Removing bulk mid-shaft with thinning shears.



figure 14-68
Slicing on hair surface to remove bulk.



Removing Weight from the Ends

Removing weight from the ends helps to taper or lighten the perimeter of graduated and blunt haircuts. This can be accomplished using thinning (serrated) shears by elevating the section and placing the shears at an angle

figure 14-69
Carving with shears to remove bulk.



figure 14-70
Slithering.



figure 14-71
Removing weight from the ends.



as the cuts are made or by using the comb to put the hair into position for cutting (**Figure 14-71**).

Point cutting or *notching* with regular shears can be used to reduce weight in the ends of the hair. For either of these techniques, the parting is held between the fingers, and the tips of the shears are used at vertical or diagonal angles to create points or notches in the hair (**Figure 14-72**). Typically, notching is a more aggressive type of point cutting that produces a chunkier effect at the hair ends.

Clippers and razors can also be used to remove weight from the ends of the hair as follows:

- Use the clipper-over-comb technique to put the hair ends in a position to be cut.
- Position the clipper blades under the ends of the hair.
- Use a *reverse* rotation technique with the clipper to comb through and cut the ends from one section to another.
- Razor-over-comb or freehand slicing techniques can be used to lighten hair ends with a razor.

figure 14-72
Notching.



 **REMINDER**

The haircut style will determine the point on the head at which the tapered area is blended into longer hair. Short styles, such as crew cuts and fades, have a high taper that is blended into the transition area of the crest; longer styles may be blended at or just below the occipital. There are as many variations as there are heads of hair to cut.

Recognize Basic Haircut Styles

After reading this section, you will be able to:

LO 8 Describe basic haircut styles.

As a barber, most of the haircuts you perform will result in some variation or combination of the basic haircuts discussed in this section; knowing how to perform these cuts provides the foundation from which to create customized hair designs for your clients. That said, it will be helpful to keep the following considerations in mind when discussing different haircut names and styles:

- Style names may refer to a particular haircut or a variation of a haircut, for example, taper cut or businessman's cut.

- Haircut style names may differ, or may be interpreted differently, from region to region. For example, a temple fade in the Midwest may be called a Philly fade on the East Coast and the quo vadis has been known to be called a Caesar cut in some parts of the country, when in fact, the traditional Caesar is a longer style.
- As with other expressions of fashion, haircut styles tend to be cyclical. This means that a basic style, often modified in some way, is reintroduced to the market and becomes popular again as a new trend. For example, the classic pompadour of the 1950s has returned in both its classic form and with variations or modifications that have produced a variety of pompadour fade styles.

Your familiarity with basic haircut style names will provide you with a frame of reference for discussing haircut options with your clients and the ability to perform the many variations you will encounter in the barbershop. Some classic haircut style names are the flat top, crew cut, high and tight, fade, taper, pompadour, Caesar, and quo vadis. Following is a discussion of these classic cuts and their variations.

figure 14-73
Flat top.



figure 14-74
Crew cut.



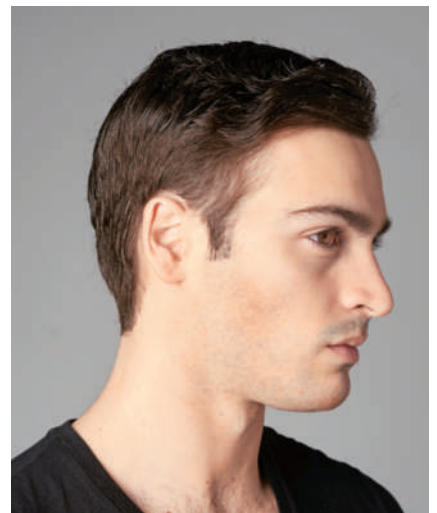
- *Flat tops* are very short on the sides and back area, with slightly longer hair at the upper parietal and front sections and a flat top section. The top of the crest area should look squared off when viewed from the front (**Figure 14-73**). A high top fade is a variation of the flat top combined with elements of a fade. Flat tops require a steady hand and consistent horizontal comb placement when cutting through the top section to ensure a balanced, level cut. Following are a few tips for flat tops:
 - The squared off crest and top sections create the “flat” look.
 - Variations of the style and length of the top section will be determined by the client’s preference, head shape, hair texture, and hair density.
 - A steady hand is needed when cutting the top section.
 - Clippers and shears are used to perform the cut.
- *Crew cuts* have short, semi-short, or medium-tapered side and back lengths with a top section that gradually increases in length from the crown to the front hairline (**Figure 14-74**). When viewed from the front, crew cuts are more rounded than flat tops in the crest area and should blend into the top section with a slight curvature that conforms to the contours of the head. Following are some basic guidelines for crew cuts:
 - The back and sides are cut relatively high to the bottom of the crest area.
 - Back and sides are tapered and blended to the crest and top sections.
 - A wide-toothed comb is used in the top section to provide a level guide.
 - The shears and comb are used to smooth out any uneven spots left by clipper work.
- *Brush* or *butch cuts* are variations of the crew cut. The sides and back are cut to a short crew-cut length, but the hair on top is uniformly cut at $\frac{1}{4}$ inch to $\frac{1}{2}$ inch and follows the contours of the head. A brush cut is styled with the hair combed back over the top section to stand straight up while the butch cut may be styled forward or to the side.

- *High and tight cuts* are cut extremely close or shaved on the sides and back to a level at the bottom, mid-point, or top of the parietal ridge, where visible hair should be seen blending with a short top section of no more than $\frac{1}{4}$ inch in length. Depending on the client's preferences, the line of demarcation at the top of the parietal ridge can either be left as is or be blended into the top section.
- The *fade style* derives its name from the fact that the hair is longest in the top section and gradually fades down to nothing at the hairline. Like the *high and tight cut*, the back and sides are cut extremely close, or shaved, with the hair becoming gradually longer at the parietal ridge and longest at the top (**Figure 14-75**). Like other basic styles discussed, there are many variations of fades that can be performed on a variety of hair textures. Following are some general guidelines for fade styles:
 - Cut the top section to the desired length.
 - Cut the nape up to the occipital to the desired length (bald, shadow, etc.).
 - The parietal ridge is the transition area between the sides and top sections; most of the blending and close tapering occurs in this area.
 - Be guided by the natural hair growth pattern to avoid creating gaps and patches.
- A *taper cut* is a well-blended, graduated cut that conforms to the head shape. A proper taper cut gradually increases in length from the hairline to the top section without any gaps or steps (**Figure 14-76**). Typically, the top section is left long enough to provide different styling options for parted and off-the-face styles. The basic taper cut may also be called a regular taper or standard haircut with variations that include the businessman's cut, Ivy League, Princeton, and precision cut. Taper cuts can vary in length and volume from short and close to long and full, but all tapers should conform to the natural head shape. When performing a taper cut, you will need to ask your client if he wants a natural taper at the nape or if he wants it blocked. Refer to Procedures 14-4 through 14-8 for guidelines on how to complete the precision cut, basic taper cut, razor cut, flat top and crew cut, and temple fade. Following are some general guidelines for taper cuts:
 - Use the fingers-and-shear technique in the top and crest sections.
 - Taper nape and side hairlines using freehand clipper or clipper-over-comb cutting.
 - Taper through the back and sides using clipper-over-comb or shear-over-comb techniques.

figure 14-75
Close fade.



figure 14-76
Taper cut.



- P 14-4** Precision Cut *pages 431–438*
- P 14-5** Basic Taper Cut *pages 439–443*
- P 14-6** Razor Cut *pages 444–448*
- P 14-7** Flat Top and Crew Cut *pages 449–454*
- P 14-8** Temple Fade *pages 455–458*

figure 14-77
Precision cut.



figure 14-78
Classic pompadour.



figure 14-79
Pompadour fade.



- A *precision cut* taper describes a variation in the cutting technique rather than a style description (Figure 14-77). The majority of the cut is performed using the fingers-and-shear cutting technique to taper and blend the hair from one section to another. A general rule to follow for using precision cutting on various hair textures is this: if the hair can be parted and picked up between the fingers to be put into a position for cutting, precision cutting can be performed. The hair should be clean and uniformly moist to enable you to maintain control of the hair while cutting and to produce the most precise cut.
- The *classic pompadour* is basically a medium to long taper cut with a long top section. Depending on the client's preferred length (short, medium, or long), the taper begins at the hairline and gradually increases in length through the back and sides to a long layered front and top section (Figure 14-78). Layering in the top section provides many styling options, from a slicked-back look to a full or spiky front section. Today's pompadour fade variation combines the very short nape, back, and side sections of a fade with the extra long top section of the classic cut. Compare Figures 14-78 and 14-79 to see the blended lengths of the classic pomp and the demarcation between lengths of the pomp fade. Refer to Procedures 14-9 through 14-11 for guidelines on how to complete the pompadour fade, fade haircut with star design, and shadow fade cut. Following are some general guidelines for pompadour cuts:
 - Length increase in the top section can be achieved by using overdirection from the front to the crown or by using a diagonal cutting line that is shorter at the crown and increasingly longer toward the front.
 - When performing the classic pompadour, use vertical partings and steep, diagonal cutting lines to blend short sides to longer top lengths.
 - Be sure to have the client confirm what type of pompadour he desires: classic or pomp fade style.

P 14-9 Pompadour Fade pages 459–464

P 14-10 Fade Haircut with Star Design pages 465–468

P 14-11 Shadow Fade Cut pages 469–472

- The *classic Caesar* style is cut with shears to create short, *uniform* layers from 1 to 2 inches throughout the head form (Figure 14-80). These short layers are often styled forward and down over the front hairline and may have a rounder appearance than other cuts. Today's versions of the Caesar may incorporate tapering or fading in the side and back areas with a uniform length in the top section that is styled forward. Following are some general guidelines for a Caesar:
 - Older clients may not be familiar with new variations of the Caesar cut, so you will have to explain the differences to them to confirm what type of Caesar they have in mind.

figure 14-80
Caesar cut.



figure 14-81
Quo vadis.



- The fingers-and-shear technique is used to cut the hair at 90-degree elevations to create uniform layers within the cut.
- The classic quo vadis is sometimes confused with the Caesar, so again, be sure your client confirms his expectations before you begin the cut.
- The *quo vadis* is another uniformly cut style; however, clippers are used to achieve its close, even-all-over length (Figure 14-81). This haircut style, which generally is suitable for most hair textures, conforms to the contours of the head and produces a more uniformly consistent appearance on medium to thick hair. Following are general guidelines for the quo vadis style:
 - The even-all-over length will depend on the client's preferences.
 - Select a blade size that will leave the hair at the desired length.
 - Be guided by the natural hair growth pattern to avoid creating gaps and patches.
 - Remember that cutting against the grain leaves the hair shorter than cutting with the grain.

Explain Haircut Finish Work

After reading this section, you will be able to:

LO9 Describe haircut finish work.

Once you have finished the haircut, you should include finishing work in your customer service routine. A neck or outline shave, an eyebrow trim, and the removal of stray hair from the ears or nostrils are standard procedures included in finishing work. Offering to perform these finishing touches after every haircut provides a professional barbershop experience for your clients and helps you build your client base and new referrals.

SHAVING THE OUTLINE AREAS

Performing a neck shave or outline shave as a feature of the haircut service contributes to the appearance of the finished cut and should follow outlining work performed with shears, clippers, or trimmers.

- The traditional *neck shave* consists of shaving the sides of the neck and across the nape with a razor.
- The *outline shave* starts at the bottom of the sideburns, arches around and behind the ears, down the sides of the neck, and across the nape. The front hairline is often included as part of the outline shave in many African American styles.

figure 14-82
The eyebrow trim.



figure 14-83
Head shaving has grown in popularity.



TRIMMING THE EYEBROWS

Eyebrow trimming may require a combination of techniques, depending on the length and density of brow hair.

- Shear-over-comb is the most popular technique for eyebrow trimming, but an outliner-over-comb technique can be used as well.
- Freehand shear cutting is sometimes required to cut individual stray hairs that extend beyond the natural arch of the brow and should be done carefully.
- Safety and protection of the client's eyes should always be the first consideration when using any eyebrow-trimming technique (**Figure 14-82**).

TRIMMING EXCESS NOSTRIL AND EAR HAIR

Outliners with T-shaped blades or nose hair trimmers are the safest tools to use for trimming excess hair from the nostrils.

- If you are using a T-bladed trimmer, simply grasp the tip of the nose between your thumb and index finger and gently tilt it up or to the side.
- Position the first few teeth of the blades on a slight diagonal to trim the hairs.
- Follow the manufacturer's directions when using nose hair trimmers, as there are several styles available on the market.
- Trimming excess hair in or around the ears is also performed with an outliner or trimmer; some barbers prefer a T-bladed tool because it is easier to maneuver in small tight areas.
- Always dust off residual hair in and around the ears after trimming.

DISCUSS HEAD SHAVING

The shaved head is one of today's fashion trends that many men choose regardless of the density or growth pattern of their hair (**Figure 14-83**). The hair and scalp are prepared with hot towels and lather followed by straight-razor shaving. Following are some guidelines for performing a head shave:

- Thoroughly analyze the scalp to identify moles and other hypertrophies.
- If you are precutting the hair, leave enough length for the razor to grab as the blade passes over the scalp.

- Keep the scalp moist and your stretching (nondominant) hand dry.
- Stretch the skin to create a smooth shaving surface.

P 14-12 The Head Shave *pages 473–476*

Identify Styling Techniques

After reading this section, you will be able to:

LO10 Describe basic styling techniques.

Hairstyling is the art of arranging the hair into an appropriate style following a haircut or shampoo service. Today, many haircuts require minimal hairstyling techniques due to the quality of the cuts, current styles, and the availability of effective styling aids such as gels, pomades, and styling sprays. Other haircuts require more styling attention, such as blowdrying or picking the style into place. In this section, the methods discussed for styling men's hair include natural drying, finger styling, scrunch styling, finger waving, blowdrying, and blow waving.

DESCRIBE BASIC STYLING TECHNIQUES

Many men prefer quick and easy styling routines. Review the following section to learn about some of these methods.

Natural Drying

As the name implies, *natural drying* is the term used when the hair is left to air-dry naturally. Typically, the hair is combed into place or arranged with the fingers and allowed to dry in place. Gels, pomades, or other styling products can be applied to hold the hair in place while it dries or can be applied after the hair is dry. Since it is not a good idea for both aesthetic and health reasons to let a client leave the shop with damp hair, use a heat lamp or blowdryer with diffuser to speed up the drying process.

Describe Finger Styling

When *finger styling* the hair, you will use your fingers to manipulate the hair into place instead of a comb or brush (**Figure 14-84**). Some clients prefer the more textured look that finger styling produces as opposed to the smoother looks achieved with combs or brushes. Using a blowdryer during the procedure is optional and will usually depend on the degree of dampness of the hair.

Scrunch Styling

Scrunch styling is actually a form of finger styling that is typically used on wavy to curly hair patterns with enough length to create a tousled look. A diffuser attachment on the blowdryer will allow only the heat to transfer while you lift and squeeze the hair between your fingers. Wavy and curly hair may require the application of a spray gel or a light

figure 14-84
Finger styling the hair.



figure 14-85
Scrunch styling technique.



figure 14-86
Freeform blowdrying using the fingers.



FOCUS ON
Keep the air and the hair moving when blowdry styling to prevent burning the client's scalp.

pomade to reduce the frizzy hair ends that sometimes accompany these hair textures (**Figure 14-85**).

Finger Waving

Finger waving is a wet styling technique that involves the process of shaping and directing the hair into an S pattern using the fingers, comb, and styling lotion. Finger waving was popular for both men and women during the 1920s and 1930s and is still used today either to direct the hair into a flat, sleek, wave formation or to add volume and direction to a section of hair when dried (see Chapter 16: Women's Haircutting and Styling).

Practice Blowdry Styling

Blowdrying not only accelerates the hair drying process but also allows you to temporarily straighten or give direction to the hair to create a more finished look. **Blowdry styling** (BLOH-dry sti-hyl-ing) is the technique of drying and styling damp hair in one operation and has revolutionized the hair care industry. While some men may not wish to do more than comb their hair into place and let it dry, the use of a blowdryer offers some options for speed-drying and special-effects styling, such as blow waving. Refer to Procedure 14-13 for guidelines on blowdrying techniques.

P 14-13 Blowdrying Techniques *pages 477–478*

The implements used with a blowdryer include combs, picks, and a variety of brushes. In most cases, the texture of the hair and the desired effect will dictate the type of implement to use. The blowdrying techniques discussed in this section are freeform, stylized or blow waving, and diffused.

Freeform Drying

Freeform blowdrying is a quick, easy method of drying the client's hair that is probably most like the techniques men use at home. This technique can build fullness into the style while allowing the hair to fall into the natural lines of the cut (**Figure 14-86**). Some barbers choose freeform blowdrying for the following reasons:

- It shows the client the ease with which the style can be duplicated.
- It demonstrates the quality of the haircut as the hair falls into place.
- The blowdrying service is accelerated.
- It allows the barber to check the accuracy of the work as the hair falls into place.

Stylized Drying

Stylized blowdrying creates a more finished appearance because each section is dried in a definite direction with the aid of a comb or brush followed by the dryer. Heat makes physical changes in the hair when using the blowdryer in this fashion and *sets* the hair in a particular direction for a look that is smoother and more precisely directed overall. Dry the hair underneath first to avoid missing damp sections and to speed up the drying process.

If you are using styling products, be sure to select one that allows manipulation of the hair, rather than one that sets the hair in place, while it is being dried and styled (Figures 14-87 to 14-89).

- When a comb or brush and the blowdryer are used to create wave patterns and direction in the hair, the technique is called *blow waving* or *air waving* (Figures 14-90 and 14-91).

Diffused Drying

Diffused drying is used when the client desires to maintain the natural wave pattern of the hair, as opposed to temporarily straightening it with the blowdryer and brush. A diffuser attachment on the blowdryer is an effective option when arranging or picking out very curly hair textures, manipulating sculpting with styling products, or when scrunching the hair (Figure 14-92).

figure 14-87
Styling the side section with blowdryer and brush.



figure 14-88
Styling and drying the top section.



figure 14-89
Finish work over the surface of the hairstyle. Follow the brush with the dryer.



figure 14-90
Create a ridge or bend in the hair near the scalp with the comb.



figure 14-91
Set the ridge with heat from the blowdryer.



figure 14-92
Diffuser.



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Building Volume

Occasionally, extra volume is needed in the crown, crest, or top areas of a style to create a more proportionate look. To build volume or to create an even contour throughout the hairstyle, use the blowdryer and brush in the following manner:

1. Lift the hair with the brush, bending the section as the blowdryer is directed at the base of the section and followed through to the ends. Avoid burning the scalp.
2. Follow the same procedure to build fullness on the sides. Use horizontal partings if the hair is to be styled down on the sides and vertical or diagonal partings if the hair will be brushed back.

BRAIDS AND LOCKS

The techniques associated with styling the hair into braids and locks is a form of natural hair care that originated in Africa thousands of years ago. Natural hair care has gained such popularity that an entirely new division of the hair care industry has developed. As a recognized professional segment of our industry, natural hair care is an active and exciting division that is currently advocating for education, licensing, and legislative changes to meet the needs of its educators, practitioners, and clients. Refer to Procedures 14-14 through 14-16 for guidelines on to complete braids and locks.

P 14-14 Cornrow Braiding *pages 479–482*

P 14-15 Starting Locks with Nubian Coils *pages 483–485*

P 14-16 Cultivating and Grooming Locks *pages 486–488*

Braids

While there are many variations of braids and braiding styles, on-the-scalp cornrows are one of the most popular styles worn today (**Figure 14-93**).

Cornrows require working close to the scalp across the curves of the head. The braid may begin at the nape, top, or sides depending on the desired finished result.

Locks

Locks, also known as *dreadlocks*, are created from natural-textured hair that is intertwined together to form a single network of hair (**Figure 14-94**). **Hair locking** (HAYR lock-ing) is the process that occurs when coiled hair is allowed to develop in its natural state without the use of combs, heat, or chemicals. The more coil revolutions within a single strand, the faster the hair will coil and lock.

Cultivated locks are those that are intentionally guided through the natural process of locking. There are several ways to cultivate locks, such as double twisting, coiling, palm rolling, braiding, and wrapping with cord.

figure 14-93
Finished cornrows.



figure 14-94
Dreadlocks.



When consulting with a client who is considering locks, you should stress the following points:

- Once they are locked, locks can only be removed by cutting them off.
- The hair locks in progressive stages that can take from 6 months to a year to complete.
- General maintenance includes regular shop visits for cleaning, conditioning, and rerolling. Once the hair locks into compacted coils, it may be shampooed regularly and managed with a non-petroleum-based oil. Heavy oils should be avoided.

Two basic methods for locking men's hair, which is traditionally shorter at the beginning of the locking process, are the comb technique and the palm- or finger-rolling method (**Figures 14-95** and **14-96**).

Discuss Safety Precautions for Haircutting and Styling

After reading this section, you will be able to:

LO 11 Discuss haircutting and styling safety precautions.

It is your responsibility as a barber to practice safety precautions daily in the performance of your work. Review the following reminders to meet the safety standards of a professional barber:

- Use all tools and implements in a safe manner.
- Use the right tool for the job.
- Always use a neck strip or towel as a barrier between the cape and the client's neck.
- Use smooth movements when raising or lowering chairs and seat backs.
- Properly clean, disinfect, and store tools and implements.
- Avoid applying dryer heat in one place on the head for too long.
- Keep metal combs away from the scalp when using heat.
- Keep the work area organized and cleaned and disinfected.
- Sweep the floor after every client and dispose of hair clippings appropriately.

Procedures 14-1 to 14-16

After reading and practicing Procedures 14-1 to 14-16, you will be able to:

LO 12 Demonstrate basic haircuts and styling techniques.

figure 14-95
Spiral the hair with the comb.



figure 14-96
Roll the hair or lock between the palms.



FINGERS-AND-SHEAR CUTTING TECHNIQUES

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ All-purpose styling comb
- ☐ Hair clips
- ☐ Haircutting cape
- ☐ Haircutting shears
- ☐ Mannequin head and stand/clamp
- ☐ Neck strips
- ☐ Spray bottle with water

PREPARATION

- 1 Shampoo and condition the mannequin.
- 2 Set up the mannequin
- 3 Drape the mannequin for the haircut

PROCEDURES

A. CUTTING ABOVE THE FINGERS HORIZONTALLY

- 1 Palm the shears, comb through the top section of the hair, and create a part on the left side. Comb the hair over the top to the right.
- 2 At the front part of the crown, position the comb at about a 45-degree angle relative to the surface of the head. Use the first few teeth of the comb to part off a ¼-inch-thick parting.



- 3 Comb the hair in front of the parting forward and away from you. With the teeth of the comb facing you, comb through the parting with the first two fingers of the opposite hand underneath the comb as you position the parting at a 90-degree elevation. Leave about an inch of hair extending beyond your fingers. The fingers and comb should be in a horizontal position parallel to the floor.
- 4 Palm the comb in the opposite hand while simultaneously positioning the shears at the tip of the fingers holding the hair section. Check the position of your fingers and shears for parallel placement.
- 5 Cut the hair projecting from between your fingers from the tips no further than the second knuckle.

B. CUTTING ABOVE THE FINGERS VERTICALLY ON THE RIGHT SIDE

- 6 Palm the shears, comb through the hair, and make a vertical part from the top of the crest to the hairline on the right side of the mannequin.
- 7 Part off a ¼-inch-thick vertical parting in front of the first parting.
- 8 With the teeth of the comb facing you in a vertical position, comb through the vertical section of hair with the fingers of the opposite hand following underneath the teeth of the comb to position the hair at a vertical 90-degree elevation. Your fingers and the comb should be in a vertical position with about an inch of hair extending beyond your fingers.



- 9 Palm the comb and cut the hair projecting from between your fingers from the tips no further than your second knuckle.

C. CUTTING BELOW THE FINGERS AT THE PERIMETER

- 10 Palm the shears and part off the hair into four sections from ear to ear and from front to nape. Use a clip to secure the hair at the sides.
- 11 Part off a ¼-to ½-inch horizontal parting along the hairline from each back section. Secure the hair remaining above the partings with clips.
- 12 Comb through the partings and leave about an inch of hair extending beyond your fingers. The fingers and comb should be in a horizontal position.
- 13 Palm the comb in the opposite hand while simultaneously positioning the tips of the shears just below the fingertips holding the hair section. Cut the hair projecting from between your fingers from the tips no further than the second knuckle.



- 14 Turn your palm up while holding the section to practice palm-to-palm cutting.

ARCHING TECHNIQUES



HERE'S A TIP

Before beginning **arching** (ARE-ching), check to determine if one sideburn is longer than the other. Start on the side with the shorter sideburn to avoid unnecessary repetition of the procedure.

MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- All-purpose comb
- Haircutting cape
- Neck strips
- Outliner
- Razor and blade
- Shears

PREPARATION

- 1 Wash your hands.
- 2 Conduct a client consultation.
- 3 Drape the client for the haircut service.
- 4 Face the client toward the mirror and lock the chair.

PROCEDURES

A. ARCHING TECHNIQUE WITH SHEARS

- 1 Gently tug the client's ear down.



- 2 Start the outline on the right side as close to the natural hairline as possible.



- 3 Start in front of the ear and cut a continuous outline around the ear and down the side of the neck.



4 Reverse direction and arch back to the starting point.



5 Square off and establish the length of the right sideburn.



6 Repeat these steps on the left side using a backhand shear position to cut around the ear.



B. ARCHING TECHNIQUE WITH OUTLINER



7 Use the first few teeth of the outliner T-blade to start the arching in front of the ear.



8 Arch around the ear using the T-blade in the same manner.



9 Continue arching around the ear; then reverse the direction.

C. ARCHING TECHNIQUE WITH RAZOR

10 Apply shaving cream to the bottom of the sideburn and around the ear.



11 Shave the bottom of the sideburn using the freehand stroke.



- 12 Gently bend or fold the ear out of the way to shave at the hairline in front of and over the ear.
-



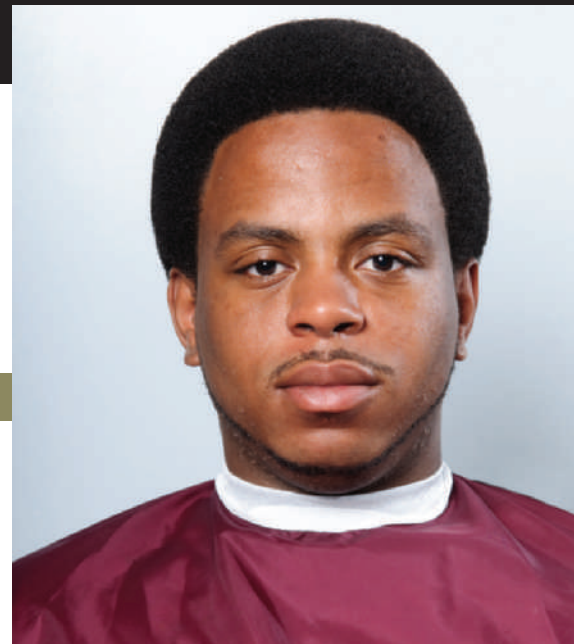
- 13 Shave in back of the ear to the corner of the nape.
-



- 14 Repeat the procedure on the left side, using the backhand and reverse backhand strokes.
-

OUTLINE SHAVE

Note: An outline shave involves shaving the bottom of the sideburns, around and behind the ears, the nape area, and, when appropriate for the hairstyle, the front hairline. This procedure provides the steps for a complete outline shave.



MATERIALS, IMPLEMENTS, AND EQUIPMENT

- ☐ Disposable barber towels
- ☐ Haircutting cape
- ☐ Neck strips
- ☐ Shaving cream or gel
- ☐ Straight razor and blades
- ☐ Terry cloth towels

PREPARATION

- 1 Client should still be draped from the haircut service.
- 2 Disinfect razor and blades.
- 3 Wash your hands.
- 4 Loosen the cape and apply towel to neckline, leaving it loose enough for access to the nape when securing the drape.

PROCEDURE

- 1 Apply a light coating of lather at the front hairline.



- 2 Stand at a slight diagonal to the client. Stretch the skin at the forehead and shave from the center along the front hairline to the temple area using the freehand stroke.



- 3 Shave from the temple along the hairline to the front of the sideburn.



- ④ Apply lather around and behind the ear. Using the freehand stroke, begin shaving in front of the ear; then hold the ear away and shave around the ear.



- ⑤ Shave behind the ear and down the side of the neck using the freehand stroke.



- ⑥ Move to the client's left side and reapply lather at forehead. Stretch the skin at the forehead area and repeat freehand strokes to the temple.

- ⑦ Use the backhand stroke to shave from the temple to the front sideburn area.



8 Apply lather around and behind the ear. Use the free-hand stroke to shave in front of and around the ear at the hairline, holding the ear away with the fingers.



9 Use the reverse backhand stroke to shave behind the ear and down the side of the neck.



10 Shave the nape area with a freehand stroke.

11 Clean up the hairline with a warm, moist towel. Apply astringent, moisturizing cream, talc, or after-shave lotion as desired.

CLEAN-UP AND DISINFECTION

- ☐ Clean and disinfect the tools and implements.
- ☐ Clean and then disinfect the work area.
- ☐ Sweep up hair and deposit in closed receptacle.
- ☐ Deposit used blades in a sharps container.
- ☐ Dispose of single-use items. Place all used linens, towels, and capes in the laundry.
- ☐ Wash your hands.